



Student Affairs



REGISTERED STUDENT ORGANIZATION (RSO) HANDBOOK

Your go-to guide for RSO information, procedures,
policies, and resources.

2026-2027

Table of Contents

Change Log	5
Introduction	6
Student Organizations Overview	7
Registered Student Organizations (RSOs)	7
Other Student Groups (Non-registered Groups)	8
RSO Membership and Leadership	8
Organization Pathways, Types, and Categories	10
Annual Organization Requirements	11
Chapter Finances	12
Recruitment Information	12
Expectations, Policies, and Accountability	14
Minimum Expectations	14
Policies Governing Student Organizations	14
Anti-Hazing	15
Prohibiting Collaboration with Suspended Organizations	16
Organization Names	17
Political Campaign Activities	18
Enforcement and Accountability	20
Addressing Member Misconduct	22
Incident Reporting	23
RSO Advising and Support	24
Overview	24
Student Org Newsletter	26
Annual Requirements, Training, and Re-Registration	27
Registered Student Organization Annual Requirements	27
Failure to Complete Annual Requirements	29
Organization Finances	30
Organization Finances Overview	30
Student Organization Finances Accounts	31
General Student Org Financial Policies	33
Sources of Funds	35
Collecting and Depositing Funds	38
Spending Organizational Funds	40
Payment Methods	41
Club Sports Finances	45
Events, Meetings, and Activities	46
Event Registration and Approval	46
Guidelines for All Student Organization Events	47
Contracts Overview	47

Steps to Processing a Contract	49
Inviting GW Executive Leadership to Events	50
Photos and Video Recording at Events	50
Ticket Sales	51
Free Expression Activities	51
Showing TV Shows, Movies, & Other Films	52
Hosting an Event with Amplified Sound	52
Hosting an Event with Food	53
Hosting a Fundraising Event	54
Hosting an Event with Minors	54
Insurance, Waivers, and Planning Events with Risky Activities	55
Events Requiring University Police	56
Hosting an Event with Outside Sponsorship and/or External Organizations	56
Hosting an Event with a Raffle or Charitable Game	57
Single-Use Plastics Policy	57
Events with Alcohol	58
Booking Space On Campus	59
Booking Space Overview	59
How to Book Spaces on Campus	59
Cancellation of Space	61
Organization Storage and Office Space	62
Overview	62
Storage Lockers	62
Organization Offices	63
Organization Travel	66
Domestic Travel	66
International Travel Overview	70
International Travel Applications	71
GW Brand, Merchandise, and Copyright Guidelines	73
GW Brand Guidelines and Purchasing Merchandise	73
Copyrighted Materials	74
Fair Use	74
Public Domain and Image Libraries	75
Common Copyright Situations	75
Publicity, Marketing, and Communications	77
Postering Guidelines	77
Tabling	78
GW Email Address and Listservs	78
Media - Campus Press and External Press	79
Honor Society Email Invitation Guidelines	79
Additional Information and Resources	80

Awards and Recognition	80
Organizational Conflict Management	80
Mail and Packages	81
Officer Transition	81
Appendix 1: Club Sports Additional Information	82
DSE Platform Requirements and User Guide	82
Club Sports Travel Rules and Regulations	82
Requesting Rental Cars, Vans, Buses, Hotels, and Flights for Club Sports	83
Athletic Training / Injury Resources	84
Team Uniforms, Apparel, and Logo Management	84
Club Sports Finances	85
Appendix 2: Events with Alcohol	86
Policy	86
Definitions	91

Change Log

The following are substantive changes to the RSO Handbook for the 2026-2027 academic year as of September 24, 2026.

Section	Change Description
Overall	Revised references and procedures throughout the RSO Handbook to account for the transition from Engage to RevConnect .
Student Organization Overview	Updated to reflect revised Pathways which were updated to improve clarity and better address different levels of organizational operations and needs.
Expectations, Policies, and Accountability	Published new Prohibiting Collaboration with Suspended Organizations policy
Advising and Support	Transitioned to a new hybrid advising model Most RSOs will be able to self-select a faculty or staff member to serve as their primary advisor, while higher activity or specialized RSOs will be assigned to a staff advisor
Annual Requirements, Training, and Re-Reg	Updated requirements in alignment with Pathway revisions
Organization Finances	RevConnect Highlights • Removed duplicative processes (i.e., no Google forms) • The credit card portal is now fully integrated into RevConnect and can be used for member dues, event tickets, and stores • Revenue is now called “group funds” • Purchase requests are now called “payment requests” Refined the scope of the University-Wide Programs Fund (UWPF) • To improve fund clarity and sustainability, the fund will focus specifically on three core categories of programming Added language on tax considerations for fundraising sales • Merchandise and goods sales are subject to a 6% DC sales tax • Food sales are subject to a 10% DC sales tax • Tax will be removed before the remainder is deposited into an RSO’s group funds (revenue)
Booking Space on Campus	• Updated to reflect changes in process and points of contact for non-academic space bookings • Removed “Scheduler” role as an officer position Any officer can book space on behalf of their RSO
Organization Travel	Revised student driver mileage allowances and time restrictions

Introduction

The Division for Student Affairs oversees the recognition, management, and development of registered student organizations (RSOs) at GW. Student Affairs, in collaboration with campus partners, develops policies, procedures, and resources to guide RSO operations.

The Student Organization Handbook is the primary source of information about RSO benefits and expectations, policies, and support. RSO leaders should familiarize themselves with Handbook contents and consult their Advisor or Org Help with questions. The Handbook is regularly reviewed and updated, so be sure to bookmark the Handbook website to stay informed about the most current guidelines.

Note: With the diversity of RSO operations and needs, we cannot anticipate or document all situations that may arise. Reach out to your Advisor or Org Help with questions on areas that may not be directly referenced within the Handbook. The absence of reference to a policy or process does not always indicate the lack thereof.

Student Organizations Overview

Registered Student Organizations (RSOs)

A registered student organization (RSO) is a student-led group recognized by the Division for Student Affairs. RSOs are established and managed by currently enrolled students who share a common interest or goal. Recognition grants organizations a range of benefits, privileges, and responsibilities.

Prospective organizations must complete a [new organization recognition process](#). The process evaluates areas such as uniqueness of mission, sustainability of operations, and added value. Risk, safety, and resource availability are also considered. The Division for Student Affairs reserves the right to reevaluate an organization's recognition if these circumstances change.

Recognition of an RSO is not to be interpreted as an endorsement or approval by the George Washington University of the organization's purpose, mission, or activities.

References to "RSO," "organization," and "student organization" throughout this handbook refer to official registered student organizations unless otherwise noted.

Benefits of Recognition

RSOs gain access to various benefits and privileges, which vary by [Pathway](#). Benefits include:

- Access to **Org Help** and the **Student Organization Resource Center (SORC)**
- Use of the **RevConnect platform** to manage operations, promote events, communicate with members, and host a website
- Access to a **university-provided email account** for your organization
- Ability to **reserve campus spaces**
- **Posting and advertising** privileges in accordance with the university's poster policy
- Participation in **student organization fairs**
- Assistance in identifying a faculty or staff member to serve as an **organization Advisor** or the assignment of an Advisor for organizations that meet specific criteria
- Facilitation of purchases by the **Org Help** team or other assigned staff support
- Use of the university's **tax-exempt status** on most purchases and ability to partner with local/national businesses on fundraisers as a non-profit organization
- Eligibility for **Student Government Association (SGA) funding**
- Ability to utilize the **George Washington University name, brand, and registered trademarks** in accordance with branding guidelines
- Use of the Division for Student Affairs' **address for mail and package delivery**: 800 21st Street NW, Suite 204, Washington, DC 20052
- Access to **car rentals** from approved vendors for approved organizational travel
- Option to apply for **office space and/or storage space**

Other Student Groups (Non-registered Groups)

Academic and university departments may convene student groups to support their mission, provide a student perspective, and enhance their daily operations. These are distinguished from registered student organizations in that they are managed by the affiliated department, are not eligible for registered student organization benefits, and are not governed by this Handbook. The department is responsible for providing support to and oversight of the student group. These groups must abide by university policies and follow guidance from their affiliated department.

Additionally, students may form groups outside the registered student organization process to create community around a shared interest. These groups do not receive university recognition or registered student organization benefits. The group and its affiliated students must abide by university policies, including the Code of Student Conduct.

RSO Membership and Leadership

Officer Eligibility and Responsibilities

Officers are elected or appointed members of an RSO who are responsible for managing the organization and serving as the organization's representatives to the university.

- Only currently enrolled GW students may hold an officer position. Individual organizations may establish additional eligibility requirements for leadership roles in their [constitution](#) or bylaws.
- The organization's governing documents should outline officer positions, term lengths, and selection method, as well as the basic roles and expectations of each officer.
- Officers must be assigned the appropriate position on the organization's RevConnect officer roster. Outgoing officers should be removed following an officer transition.
- Organizations can use RevConnect to facilitate elections using [Surveys & Forms](#).

Officers are responsible for the organization's actions, conduct, and activities. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Ensuring payment for services and supplies
- Reviewing communications from the Division for Student Affairs, Advisors, and Org Help and disseminating information as appropriate
- Completing required training and management tasks to maintain recognition
- Proactively reaching out to your Advisor or Org Help with questions and concerns
- Educating members on and ensuring compliance with relevant policies and procedures

Required Positions

To maintain official RSO status, each organization must designate, at a minimum, the following positions:

- **President**
- **Financial Officer**

- **One additional officer** of the organization's choosing

These officer roles must be held by separate individuals. The individuals in these roles must be assigned the appropriate position on the organization's RevConnect officer roster.

Club Sports: Club Sports teams must also designate at least one **Safety Officer** in Do Sports Easy (DSE). Safety officers must have CPR credentials, are responsible for ensuring the club has a fully stocked medkit on site for matches, and must book an athletic trainer for home matches.

Events with Alcohol: Organizations wishing to host an event with alcohol must also designate at least one **risk manager** on their event registration. The risk manager must complete the appropriate training annually before an organization may host an event with alcohol.

Membership

General Membership Criteria

- All members must be currently registered and enrolled students of the university.
- To form and maintain registration status, organizations must have at least 10 members who are currently enrolled GW students.
- Individuals who are not GW students (including alumni, family, external advisors) are considered guests of the organization. Guests may attend events, but cannot hold officer positions, vote, or handle money on behalf of the organization.

Types of Organization Membership

RSOs may choose to be open to all current students or choose to set selective membership criteria.

Selective membership requirements must comply with the university's [Equal Opportunity, Nondiscrimination, Anti-Harassment, and Non-Retaliation Policy](#).

- **Open Membership:** The RSO is open to all currently enrolled GW students in a degree-granting program, with no additional selection criteria beyond interest in the organization.
- **Selective Membership:** The RSO is not open to all GW students and has established membership criteria that relates to the mission of the organization and abides by university policies, including non-discrimination policies, with [limited exceptions](#) provided by Title IX for Social Fraternities and Sororities (IFC, MGC, NPHC, PHA) and Club Sports.

Criteria for membership in a selective RSO must be outlined in the organization's approved [constitution](#) in RevConnect. Example of what can and cannot be used for selective membership criteria include:

- **Does not meet criteria:** The membership of the Student Life Singers is open to all men and male-identifying students who are selected through tryouts conducted every September.
- **Meets criteria:** The membership of the Student Life Singers is open to tenor and bass singers who are selected through tryouts conducted every September.
- **Does not meet criteria:** The membership of the Student Affairs Young Professionals is limited to students who are 18-25 years old.

- **Meets criteria:** The membership of the Student Affairs Young Professionals is open to all students who seek to empower young professionals in the field of Student Affairs.

Note: RSOs with a new member process may be required to [complete training](#) to comply with state law. See GW [Anti-Hazing Policy](#) and [Adam's Law](#). Details will be shared with qualifying groups.

Organization Pathways, Types, and Categories

Student Organization Pathways

The Pathways framework is designed to align resources with the actual operational needs of each registered student organization. This system prioritizes resource allocation efficiency and provides transparency regarding organizational requirements and benefits. **RSOs can view their Pathway assignment on RevConnect.** The table below provides a brief description of each.

Visit the [Pathways website](#) to learn more about specific benefits, resources, and requirements.

RSO Pathway	Description
 Red Line	RSOs that are generally very active and receive ongoing support from a university department and have a high degree of funding, contracts, high-profile events, or higher-risk activities. These organizations may have additional training needs based on their activities and are assigned to a designated Advisor.
 Blue Line	RSOs with higher amounts of contracts, spending, and travel. These organizations may have additional training needs based on their activities and are assigned to a designated Advisor.
 Orange Line	RSOs that are consistently active with events throughout the year. Advisors are required and are selected by the organization.
 Silver Line	RSOs with lower activity levels with limited needs. Benefits and training requirements are reduced to match operational needs. Advisors are optional.
 Yellow Line	
 Green Line	Reserved for the Student Bar Association (SBA) and Medical Center Student Council (MCSC) and their sub-organizations. The Division for Student Affairs works with the schools to determine benefits and requirements that consider unique circumstances.

Annual training requirements vary by Pathway. See [Annual Requirements and Training](#).

Types of Organizations

While most RSOs follow standard recognition and operations, several distinct types of registered student organizations have unique operational processes and may have additional responsibilities, expectations, or privileges. These include:

Club Sports Organizations (Red Line)

- A competitive sports team officially recognized by the Club Sports Council and the Office of Campus Recreation.
- Teams often travel frequently and compete with other universities and follow specific guidelines related to roster management, risk management, travel, and apparel.
- Club Sport organizations will be assigned to the Red Line pathway.
- See [Appendix 1: Club Sports Additional Information](#) for more details.

Department-Sponsored Organizations (Red Line)

- RSOs that have a formal and ongoing relationship with a sponsoring university department.
- Key features include:
 - A mission and set of activities aligned with the function and goals of the university unit
 - A staff advisor from the sponsoring department, often serving in this role as part of their job responsibilities
 - Collaborative programming or resources provided to the GW community
 - Potential access to departmental benefits such as space and funding
 - Select leaders may receive stipends or hold formal student employment positions that bridge the student organization and sponsoring department
- Department sponsored RSOs will be assigned to the Red Line pathway.

Fraternity and Sorority Life Organizations (Red Line)

- Social Greek-letter organizations recognized by the Division for Student Affairs' Fraternity and Sorority Life (FSL) team and one of GW's four governing councils:
 - Interfraternity Council (IFC)
 - Multicultural Greek Council (MGC)
 - National Pan-Hellenic Council (NPHC)
 - Panhellenic Association (PHA)
- Chapters follow specific accreditation and training guidelines unique to the fraternity and sorority life experience.
- FSL chapters will be assigned to the Red Line pathway.

Annual Organization Requirements

As a registered student organization, chapters recognized by Fraternity and Sorority Life (FSL) must follow the policies outlined in this handbook. FSL chapters are assigned to the Red Line Pathway and must complete the annual requirements outlined for this Pathway.

Chapters must also complete the requirements of the Fraternity and Sorority Life [Revolution Accreditation Program](#).

- Requirements are determined by a chapter's earned accreditation status from the previous academic or calendar year.
- Chapters on an academic year cycle are notified of their status in April, and chapters on a calendar year cycle are notified in December.
- Chapters deemed unaccredited by Fraternity and Sorority Life are subject to the assignment of additional requirements or interventions to restore their accredited status.

Chapter Finances

- FSL chapters must adhere to all financial processes and procedures that are required of registered student organizations.
- As council dues and other fees from councils and FSL are processed through RevConnect, chapters must proactively plan and ensure that their RevConnect Group Funds (revenue) accounts have sufficient funds to avoid a negative balance.
- External accounts must be approved by the Division for Student Affairs.

Recruitment Information

Students interested in joining the Fraternity and Sorority Life community must engage in the Recruitment process. To be eligible for the Recruitment process, students must:

- Have at least a 2.0 high school or collegiate GPA
- Complete the grade release form
- Complete the FSL 101 module
- Complete anti-hazing education

[Graduate Opt-in Umbrella Organizations \(various pathways\)](#)

- Graduate organizations that represent all sub-organizations within their respective graduate school. Each umbrella organization must have at least five sub-organizations to qualify for this status. Organizations that do not maintain five active sub-organizations are subject to revocation of umbrella status and associated benefits.
- Recognition and associated benefits require approval by the Division for Student Affairs New Organization Committee, the Student Government Association, and the respective graduate school. Prospective sub-organizations must complete the new organization process and also receive approval from the appropriate umbrella organization.
- There are currently six approved Graduate Opt-in Umbrella Organizations:
 - Elliott School Graduate Board (ESGB) | Elliott School of International Affairs
 - Graduate Business Association (GBA) | School of Business
 - GSEHD Student Council | Graduate School of Education and Human Development
 - Medical Center Student Council (MCSC) | School of Medicine and Health Services
 - Student Bar Association (SBA) | Law School
 - Public Health Student Association (PHSA) | Milken Institute School of Public Health
- Umbrella organizations serve as central leadership bodies for their sub-organizations and have the option to "opt-in" to receive a lump sum allocation of their respective students' SGA fee. If

receiving a lump sum, umbrella organizations are responsible for allocating funds to their sub-organizations.

- Operational procedures may vary based on the umbrella organization's internal structure, number of sub-organizations, or the structure and operations of the affiliated graduate school.
- The Student Organization Handbook applies to both umbrella organizations and their associated sub-organizations. Differences in operations are highlighted in relevant sections of this handbook (e.g., Finances, re-registration). If you have any questions, please contact Org Help.

Student Organization Categories

Categories allow prospective members to browse RSOs on RevConnect based on interest. RSOs are assigned one or more category(ies) that best reflect their activities and mission. Categories include:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| ● Academic / Professional | ● Recreation / Social / General Interest |
| ● Arts / Performance | ● Religious / Secular / Spiritual |
| ● Club Sports | ● Service / Advocacy / Civic Engagement |
| ● Culture / Identity / Affinity | ● Student Governance / Campus Programming |
| ● Fraternity & Sorority Life | ● Graduate |
| ● Health / Wellness | ● Undergraduate |
| ● Media / Publications | ● Undergrad / Grad |

RSOs are generally limited to no more than three categories to improve searchability. If your organization would like to request edits to your RevConnect categories, please contact orghelp@gwu.edu.

Expectations, Policies, and Accountability

POLICY HIGHLIGHTS

All activities and events hosted by an RSO must comply with applicable university policies, including the Code of Student Conduct and the Student Organization Handbook.

When a member or officer is suspected of violating the Code of Student Conduct or university policy, the organization MAY NOT investigate, sanction, or otherwise take action against a member or officer. Consult with Conflict Education and Student Accountability to determine if the behavior is a potential university policy violation or if the organization can take action.

Minimum Expectations

To be recognized by the George Washington University, registered student organizations must:

- Abide by all university policies and guidelines established for students and student organizations
- Maintain a minimum of 10 active members who are currently enrolled GW students
- Maintain accurate and up-to-date records of organization membership using their RevConnect (or DSE roster for Club Sports teams)
- Maintain accurate and up-to-date records of organization leadership using their RevConnect, including required officer positions
- Publish an updated [constitution](#) on their RevConnect group profile
- Operate in accordance with the university's non-profit and tax-exempt status
- Complete annual training requirements and complete the annual re-registration process
- Follow reasonable directions from Division for Student Affairs representatives and other university officials acting in performance of their duties

Any exception to the above and other policies throughout the Handbook must be approved and documented by the Division for Student Affairs Student Involvement team.

Policies Governing Student Organizations

The Student Organization Handbook is your primary resource for information on organizational benefits, registration requirements, policies, and available support. The Division for Student Affairs reserves the right to update and modify policies and procedures contained within this Handbook, at any time and in their sole discretion.

All events and activities hosted or co-sponsored by the organization, on or off campus, must comply in full with applicable university policies, including the regulations governing students and student organizations found within this Student Organization Handbook, and

- the [Code of Student Conduct](#) ("the Code"),
- the [Title IX Sexual Harassment and Related Conduct Policy](#),
- [Student Government Association](#) (SGA) governing documents, and
- other university policies (see [Office of Ethics, Compliance, and Risk](#)).

Depending on the group type, activity, or event, additional venue- or department-specific policies and guidelines may apply. Any additional policies established by the SGA or an organization do not supersede those of the Division for Student Affairs or university.

Commonly Referenced University Policies

Below is a non-exhaustive list of university-wide policies that are of particular importance to RSOs. The policies and guidelines within this Handbook were developed in alignment with these university policies. The Handbook may provide additional levels of expectations and guidance but will not be more broad than or contradictory to university policy.

- [Anti-Hazing Policy](#)
- [Demonstrations Policy](#)
- [Equal Opportunity, Nondiscrimination, Anti-Harassment, and Non-Retaliation Policy](#)
- [International Travel Policy](#)
- [Licensing and Trademark Guidelines](#)
- [Political Activity Policy](#)
- [Poster Policy](#)
- [Single-Use Plastics Policy](#)

Anti-Hazing

University Policies and Related Laws and Regulations

The George Washington University is committed to promoting an educational environment where students may participate in activities and RSOs without compromising their health, safety, or welfare.

Visit the university's [Anti-Hazing Policy](#) and [Hazing Prevention](#) website for information and resources.

Anti-Hazing Education

[GW HALT Hazing](#) is a comprehensive safety and leadership initiative designed to empower GW students.

To maintain active status, organizations identified as "Student Organizations with New Members" must ensure that 100% of the designated individuals complete in-person training. These are defined as officially recognized organizations where individuals do not automatically become members upon invitation and must complete a "new member period" before full initiation.

RSOs in this category will receive direct communication regarding training requirements. Visit the [Hazing Prevention at GW website](#) to learn more.

Prohibiting Collaboration with Suspended Organizations

Registered student organizations (RSOs) are prohibited from **partnering, co-hosting, or collaborating** in any capacity with student organizations that are currently under the sanction of **Suspension or Revocation of Registered Student Organization Status** by the Office of Conflict Education & Student Accountability (CESA).

Suspension is a designated period during which a student organization is not recognized by the University and does not receive the privileges afforded to registered student organization. Conditions for consideration of return from Suspension may be specified.

Revocation of Registered Student Organization Status is an indefinite separation of the student organization where the student organization is no longer recognized by the University and does not receive any of the privileges afforded to a registered student organization. The earliest the student organization may be eligible to apply for new student organization recognition is four years from the date of revocation.

Collaboration includes, but is not limited to:

- Jointly funding events or initiatives
- Co-branding marketing materials or social media content
- Multi-collaborator posts on any social media post/platform that require the collaborator to accept an invitation to co-post
- Sharing reserved campus spaces or equipment
- Co-organizing meetings, fundraisers, events, or social functions

RSOs must not act as a conduit for student organizations holding a sanction of Suspension or Revocation of Registered Student Organization Status ("Suspended Organization"). This includes:

- Advertising or promoting events, meetings, or recruitment efforts hosted by Suspended Organizations via RSO listservs, social media accounts, or flyering
- Sharing digital links or registration forms for activities led by Suspended Organizations
- Reserving space or other resources for use by Suspended Organizations

Collaboration with RSOs under other sanctions (e.g., disciplinary probation, limitation of privileges) is permitted; however, the collaboration between the RSOs must abide by those sanctions.

Verification Responsibility: It is the responsibility of the RSO leadership (President) to verify the status of a potential partner organization and their compliance with any sanctions such as a limitation of privileges prior to initiating collaboration. A list of organizations currently under disciplinary sanction can be found on the [Student Organization Conduct and Hazing Transparency Report](#).

Note: An organization remains under the status of Suspended or Revocation of Registered Student Organization Status until all sanctions are completed and there is documented approval from CESA. Absent that, the organization will remain on that status even if the period of Suspension or revoked status has lapsed. Organizations will remain on the Conduct and Hazing Transparency Report until the receipt of documented approval from CESA. RSOs with questions about the current status of a student organization that is suspended or has had its registration revoked may contact CESA at cesa@gwu.edu.

Failure to comply with this policy may result in administrative action by DSA or disciplinary action by CESA against the participating RSO, which may include, but is not limited to:

- Loss of room reservation privileges
- Freezing of organizational funds
- Review of the RSO's registration status

This policy applies to all activities, whether they occur on-campus or off-campus, provided they are conducted under the name of the Registered Student Organization.

Organization Names

The use of "GW," "George Washington," or "The George Washington University" in a registered student organization's name does not imply university endorsement of the group's philosophy, activity, or event.

RSOs may not use the name of another RSO or campus office, department, or initiative.

The Division for Student Affairs reserves the right to deny the use of names that are deemed lewd, indecent, discriminatory, denigrating, or misleading; that use trademarked references beyond allowed naming conventions; or that are related to other RSOs or campus departments to an extent that may cause confusion.

RSOs must conduct business and promotions (including, but not limited to social media, signage, and other printed material) under the name which they are registered with and listed in RevConnect.

Name Changes

RSOs may not edit their name in RevConnect. Requests for a name change can be submitted to orghelp@gwu.edu. Any changes to an organization's name or primary mission that correspond to material changes to the organization's purpose or operations may require that RSO to complete the new organization process.

External Organization Affiliation

RSOs connected with or using the name of a local, national, or international organization must receive written permission from the parent organization for use of the name. This documentation must be submitted as part of the new organization registration process and as requested by the Division for Student Affairs.

Non-registered Groups

Student groups not registered with the Division for Student Affairs may not use the university name or trademark in their group's name without the express permission of the Vice President for Student Affairs and Dean of Students.

Political Campaign Activities

Federal law prohibits tax-exempt educational institutions from directly or indirectly engaging in any political campaign activity on behalf of or in opposition to any candidate for public office. Campaign activity includes, but is not limited to, sponsoring the appearance of a declared candidate for public office, volunteering for a candidate, raising funds or canvassing for a candidate, or distributing a candidate's campaign literature.

The following guidelines apply to GW political student organizations and any similar politically active organization recognized by the Division for Student Affairs.

Nothing in this policy prohibits students from participating in campaign activity in their individual capacity separate from their relationship to a student organization or the university.

University Resources

University funds (including both organizational revenue and SGA budget funds), websites, social media, email, copiers, computers, telephones, fax machines, or other equipment or supplies may not be used on behalf of or against any candidate for public office, political party, or political action committee.

University facilities (office space, meeting rooms, lecture halls, etc.) in general may not be used on behalf of or against any candidate for public office, political party, or political action committee. If a university facility is regularly made available to non-university groups, however, such facilities may be made available for political campaign activities if (1) the facility is provided on the same terms and conditions governing the use for purposes other than political campaign activities, and (2) the facility is made available on an equal basis to other candidates.

Prohibited Campaign Activities

All political RSOs, regardless of candidate, political party, or political action committee ("PAC") affiliation, are prohibited from:

- Coordinating university fundraising with the fundraising for any candidate for public office, political party, PAC, or any similar politically active organization.
- Making or reimbursing campaign contributions.
- Purchasing supplies (paper, envelopes, banners, etc.) with university funds.

- Permitting candidates for political office to use GW facilities (including, but not limited to, mailing lists, office space, telephones, copy machines) to support the candidate or a campaign, political party, or PAC.
- Placing the university's name, marks, and seal of the university on any communications, including email and social media, intended for support for a political campaign on behalf of or against any candidate for public office, political party, or political action committee, including the solicitation of funds for such purpose or activities.
 - This does not include the use of the registered student organization's name and logo so long as the registered name and logo follow established guidelines.

Naming Convention

All political RSOs must utilize the following standard naming convention when created to support an individual candidate: "GW Students for XX" or "Students for XX."

Voter Education Activities

RSOs may conduct voter education and registration activities on or off campus. If these activities are conducted on behalf of or in opposition to a candidate or political party, rather than on a non-partisan basis, the RSO may not use university funds or resources in the planning or conduct of the campaign activity and a disclaimer (below) must be provided in any printed/online materials or oral presentations to make it clear that the activity is not supported or endorsed by the university.

Candidate Appearances

A student organization may invite individuals who have declared themselves to be candidates and/or their representatives to speak on campus on topics of interest to the students or community. Organizations must follow the contract process for guest speakers.

A student organization may invite a candidate and/or their representatives to speak on campus in connection with a campaign activity provided the student organization includes the disclaimer below in printed materials and oral introductions, and does not use university funds or resources in the planning or conduct of the campaign activity.

Fundraising, Phone/Text Banking, and Canvassing

RSOs may conduct a phone/text bank within university facilities if the student organization and the participants make it clear that the activity is not supported or endorsed by the university and does not use university funds or resources in the planning or conduct of the activity.

RSOs may not participate in campaign canvassing (i.e., door knocking) on campus.

RSOs participating in off-campus canvassing activities must make clear that the activity is not supported or endorsed by the university and may not use university funds or resources in the planning or conduct of the activity. The disclaimer below must be used in any written communication. Participants may not display the university name or trademarks in any regard (e.g., signage, printed materials, attire, stickers).

Disclaimer

Any communication, written or oral, must unambiguously convey that messaging is on behalf of individual students or their RSO, and not the university.

Political student organizations must also include the below disclaimer on their RevConnect profile, website, and social media profiles.

“The views expressed herein are solely those of the [Organization Name], and its individual members, and do not represent the endorsement of the George Washington University.”

Enforcement and Accountability

Registered student organizations, as well as their members and officers, may be held collectively and/or individually responsible for violations of the Code of Student Conduct, the Student Organization Handbook, or other university policies and procedures.

- Whether allegations, responsibility, and sanctions are assigned to individuals and/or the organization is determined on a case-by-case basis based on the totality of the information available at the time of the decision.
- Many factors are considered when determining whether an event is organizational. Each case is evaluated based on the totality of the information known. [Consult this guide \(PDF\)](#) for details on how the university evaluates organizational events.
- To support informed decisions about joining an organization, the Division for Student Affairs publishes a [list of student organizations with conduct violations](#).
- The President will represent the organization unless circumstances require a different officer to step in. In those instances, the President, assigned Advisor (where applicable), or DSA designee should designate a single alternative representative.

Addressing Reported Misconduct, Missing Requirements, or Failure to Follow Procedures

The process for resolving alleged violations of university policies depends on the nature of the incident. For instance:

- Reports involving most university policies, including the Code of Student Conduct, are referred to [Conduct Education and Student Accountability \(CESA\)](#).

- Reports involving sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating and domestic violence, and stalking are referred to the [Office of Equal Opportunity \(OEO\)](#).
- Reports involving discrimination and harassment based on a protected characteristic are referred to the [Office of Access and Opportunity \(OAO\)](#).

Other issues of non-compliance with student organization policies or administrative processes, will be reviewed by a Division for Student Affairs (DSA) representative or designee, typically from the team responsible for the policy (e.g., Student Involvement, Campus Recreation, Student Center). Common examples include:

- Failure to meet annual requirements or re-registration deadlines
- Failure to maintain membership minimums or accurate rosters
- Misuse of campus space, organization office, or storage locker
- Repeated no-shows for reserved campus spaces

The review process varies by the type of concern. In most cases, the appropriate staff member evaluates the concern and communicates outcomes based on published expectations. For more complex situations, additional information or meetings may be required before a decision is made.

RSO expectations and deadlines are outlined in this Handbook, communicated during training, or sent via email. Failure to review these resources or attending training is not an excuse for non-compliance. If you are not receiving emails, please contact orghelp@gwu.edu to update your contact information or subscription status.

If an issue involves the failure of an organization to follow their own constitution, the Student Involvement team or advisor can support the organization in finding a resolution.

The Vice President for Student Affairs and Dean of Students reserves the right to review and revoke registration status if an organization fails to meet or maintain the criteria for recognition as outlined in this Handbook.

Conduct Actions and Sanctions

The type of sanction will be determined based on the nature of the incident and all information collected during the conduct process. Sanctions may include, but are not limited to:

- Restitution
- Disciplinary probation
- Limitations on or loss of organizational benefits and privileges (e.g., event participation, event hosting, travel, booking space, spending/funding)
- Suspension
- Revocation of registration status

Additional consequences for not following administrative procedures, missing annual requirements, or other non-conduct related concerns may include:

- Warning
- Educational conversations or programming
- Conditional status
- Non-renewal resulting in inactive status and loss of recognition

Example Action for an Administrative/Non-Conduct Issues

Below is an example of a common non-compliance issue and its standard progression of consequences. Each instance will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis and may be adjusted to consider both mitigating and aggravating factors.

Space reservation no-show:

- First offense - Warning - Written notice
- Second offense - Second/final warning - Written notice
- Third offense - Suspension of privileges - Remaining reservations for semester cancelled; Space booking privileges revoked
- Meet with Events and Venues staff to be considered for reinstatement of booking privileges

The following is a non-exhaustive list of administrative reasons the Vice President for Student Affairs and Dean of Students may revoke an organization's registration status:

- Submission of material for recognition known or determined by the Division for Student Affairs to be false
- Repeated failure to maintain any recognition requirement set forth in this policy
- Failure to follow university policies and procedures or local, state, or federal laws
- Upon notification by the organization's national, regional, or other parent entity with which it is affiliated that the organization has failed to follow the rules, policies or guidelines of the organization's national, regional, or other parent entity

Addressing Member Misconduct

RSOs with concerns about the behavior of one of their members are encouraged to submit a report through one of the various reporting options offered by the university. See [Incident Reporting](#).

When a member or officer is suspected of violating the Code of Student Conduct or university policy, the RSO, officers, and members MAY NOT investigate, sanction, or otherwise take action against the individual without the written approval of the Director of Conflict Education and Student Accountability or designee.

- Alleged violations of university policy that require referral to the university include, but are not limited to, discrimination, harassment, illegal activity, sexual assault, stalking and violence, or other abuse. Student leaders can reach out to Conflict Education and Student Accountability (CESA) or the Office of Equal Opportunity (OEO) to discuss such matters. CESA and OEO are available to help student leaders navigate intermediate measures and voluntary agreements to resolve these concerns in a timely manner.

- Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so in consultation with Conflict Education and Student Accountability or other department responsible for the associated policy.

To address alleged member conduct that does not violate university policy (e.g. meeting attendance, enrollment status, upholding organization mission), organizations should work with their Advisor or Org Help to develop a process for addressing such behavior that is fair and equitable.

Incident Reporting

Every report will be treated with respect and will be addressed by the appropriate university administrative office. Concerns can be reported via [EthicsPoint](#) (including anonymously), or other various reporting avenues based on the issue subject matter.

- **Accessibility:** Barriers that affect someone's ability to access GW facilities, services, websites, or other digital content should be [reported to the University](#).
 - **Student of Concern / CARE Referral:** Students who are concerned about a member of the GW community can complete the [CARE Team Referral form](#). For more information about the CARE Team and outreach process, visit the [CARE referral website](#).
 - **Discrimination and Harassment:** All reports and complaints of discrimination or harassment on the basis of protected characteristics defined in the [Equal Opportunity, Nondiscrimination, Anti-Harassment, and Non-Retaliation Policy](#) may be reported through the [Discrimination and Harassment Report Form](#). This includes reports of bias, sexual harassment, sexual assault, domestic and dating violence, and stalking. These reports are reviewed by the [Office of Equal Opportunity](#) (OEO).
 - **Student or Organization Conduct Concern:** To report an RSO policy violation, including hazing, disorderly conduct, and poster violations, please submit an [incident report form](#).
-

RSO Advising and Support

2026-2027 ORG HELP HOURS

University Student Center 433A

Org Help Advising (Drop-in)

Monday - Friday 12:00-5:00 pm

Financial Transactions (for approved requests only)

Weekdays by appointment (in-person)

Drop-in Monday, Wednesday, and Friday 12:00-5:00 pm

Overview

Advisors and Org Help work together to provide wraparound operational support to organizations and their leaders. The Division for Student Affairs utilizes a hybrid selection and assignment process for student organization advisors. The majority of RSOs will be able to self-select a faculty or staff member to serve as their primary advisor, while higher activity or specialized RSO will be assigned a staff advisor.

Org Help

Org Help is a centralized resource for organization officers and advisors that includes email, drop-in hours, and scheduled meetings.

Regardless of Pathway and advisor status, Org Help is the primary point of contact for:

- Contracts, MOUs, Certificates of Insurance (COI)
- International and domestic travel
- Events with alcohol, permits, and other special event considerations
- Financial transactions
- Domestic travel requests and travel arrangements

Exceptions may exist for Club Sports and Green Line organizations and are noted throughout the Handbook or are communicated directly to schools and umbrella organizations.

Located in the University Student Center Room 433A, RSOs are invited to drop in at their convenience with organization questions. The Org Help desk is open for general questions (see hours above).

If the hours do not fit your schedule or you prefer to meet virtually, email orghelp@gwu.edu to schedule a meeting.

Common drop-in topics include using RevConnect, member recruitment and retention, conflict management, event planning and contracts, and policy questions.

Org Help Finance

The Org Help team reviews and processes all RevConnect payment requests and books organization travel reservations, including hotels and transportation. They also assist with the vendor registration process for guest speakers, performers, and other service providers.

Org Help offers in-person and virtual meetings for financial purchases. See hours above. While anyone may use drop-in hours to ask questions, transactions will only be completed for those who have an approved purchase request.

Advisors

Faculty and staff advisors play a vital role in the development of RSO leaders and the health of co-curricular life on campus. RSO advisors are faculty or staff members either selected by an organization or assigned by the Division for Student Affairs. Faculty and staff advisors:

- Offer mentorship, guidance, and subject matter expertise
- Help with continuity during leadership transitions
- Support organizational goal-setting and programming
- Serve as an institutional liaison
- Mitigate risk and escalate concerns as appropriate

Advisors are not an elected leader of the RSO and should act accordingly, providing support, guidance, and recommendations, with the purpose of furthering the goals defined by the students and ensuring safety and compliance with policies. Advisors working with an RSO shall not direct, coerce, or otherwise exert undue influence over an RSO or individual student's activities and conduct.

Advisor selection or assignment processes are based on [Pathways](#):

RSO Pathway	Advisor Requirement	Process
 Red Line	Required	Assigned by DSA
 Blue Line	Required	Assigned by DSA
 Orange Line	Required	Selected by organization
 Silver Line	Optional	Selected by organization
 Yellow Line	Optional	Selected by organization
 Green Line (MSSC, SBA)	Varies	Selected by organization

Advisors selected by the RSO must be mutually agreed upon and confirmed with a signed [Advisor Agreement](#), which outlines basic expectations and allows us to track RSO advisors. Potential advisors can

learn more about the role responsibilities, eligibility, and time commitment, and express interest in becoming an RSO advisor on the [student organization advising webpage](#).

External Advisors and Coaches (Non-GW)

RSOs are permitted to have external, non-GW advisors or coaches, paid or unpaid. Coaches and other individuals that are paid must be contracted and registered as a vendor with GW via PaymentWorks.

RSOs with external advisors must indicate this affiliation during the annual re-registration process and upon request by the Division for Student Affairs.

Club Sports Coach Policy Overview

Club Sport teams may have a maximum of two (2) coaches per competitive squad, and coaches may not perform any coaching duties until they are fully approved and onboarded. Coaches must maintain required liability insurance, complete a background check every five (5) years or at the end of their contract period, have appropriate campus credentials and facility access, and comply with all applicable GW policies and professional standards. Coaches may only access campus facilities and perform coaching duties during their designated season or period of performance and may not drive on behalf of the club.

All paid and volunteer coaches follow the same core approval process: the coach registers in DSE, club leadership completes a detailed Scope of Work (SOW), and the Advisor reviews it before submission through RevConnect. The coach must then complete the required background check and insurance documentation; paid coaches also complete University vendor registration and payment procedures, while volunteer coaches complete the applicable unpaid volunteer documentation. If facility access is required, Campus Recreation sponsors the coach for a GWorld card and obtains a limited-access Club Sport Coach Membership for Lerner Health and Wellness Center.

Once all requirements are completed and the coach is approved in DSE, the coach may officially begin working with the club. The process can take up to one month, so clubs should begin onboarding well in advance of the season or contract start date.

Contact [Campus Recreation](#) for additional information.

Student Org Newsletter

RSO leaders will receive regular communication through the Org Help Newsletter. During the academic year, newsletters are typically sent monthly and for timely announcements.

Unsubscribing from or failure to read the newsletter or other email announcements is not an excuse for missed deadlines or failure to comply with instructions or annual requirements. If you are not receiving these emails, contact orghelp@gwu.edu for assistance on updating your contact information or resubscribing to the newsletter.

Annual Requirements, Training, and Re-Registration

RSOs must complete a series of annual requirements to maintain their status as a registered student organization and receive access to RSO privileges. Officers will receive more detailed information through email. Opting out, failure to read emails, or failure to maintain an accurate listing of officers does not excuse an organization from meeting stated deadlines or requirements.

If you are not receiving communications about RSO operations or requirements, email orghelp@gwu.edu to update your contact information or resubscribe to the newsletter.

Failure to complete annual requirements will result in an RSO being placed in **locked** status. While locked, ROSs lose key privileges, including the ability to reserve campus space and access to funding.

Registered Student Organization Annual Requirements

Requirement Checklist & Timeline

Timing	Action	Required For
Fall (By 9/30)	Updated RevConnect Profile and Officer Listing	All Pathways
Fall (9/5 or 9/6)	Attend Student Organization Leadership Summit	Silver, Orange, Blue, Red
Fall (By 10/30)	Conduct initial advisor meeting	Orange, Blue, Red
Spring (April)	Complete Re-Registration on RevConnect	All Pathways

Updated RevConnect Profile and Officer Listing

At the start of each academic year, every RSO must update their profile information, roster, and officers in [RevConnect](#) or other agreed upon system (e.g., DSE for Club Sports). RSOs must designate a president, a financial officer, and at least one other officer of the RSO's choosing. RSO may designate additional officers as appropriate for each organization.

These designated leaders serve as the RSO's liaison to the university and are responsible for receiving essential communications from the Division for Student Affairs and ensuring the group retains its status as a registered student organization.

Advisor Meetings:

- **Required For:** Red and Blue Line RSOs should connect with their assigned advisor at least 2x per semester; Orange Line RSOs should connect with their selected advisor at least 1x per semester.

- **Format:** May be virtual or in-person based on discussion between you and your RSO advisor.

Annual Training:

RSO training equips student leaders with the essential resources, leadership skills, and administrative knowledge needed to successfully manage their organizations. The [Student Org Leadership Summit](#) is a required training for RSO officers of **Red, Blue, Orange,** and **Silver Line** organizations. By attending the Summit, your RSO can fulfill the annual training requirements for the academic year.

- **Required for:** Silver Line (1 officer); Orange, Blue, and Red Lines (2 officers)
- **Format:** In-person training

Green Line

The Division for Student Affairs will work in collaboration with SBA and MCSC to determine training and meeting requirements for these RSOs that account for the unique operations of the representative umbrella RSO and school affiliation. Details will be communicated directly with sub-organizations.

Additional Training

Red Line

- **Fraternity and Sorority Life:** All chapters associated with IFC, MGC, NPHC, or PHA councils must complete an annual accreditation process ([Revolution Accreditation Program](#)), which includes additional training requirements. More information will be provided by the FSL team.
- **Club Sports:** Campus Recreation hosts an orientation for all Club Sports teams.
- **Other Red Line or Department Organizations:** Requirements will be communicated by the Division for Student Affairs or your RSO advisor.

Events with Alcohol

Any RSO wishing to host an event with alcohol must designate a risk manager on their event registration. Risk managers must complete the [Events with Alcohol training module](#) prior to the approval of the first event with alcohol request each academic year.

Student Org Summit

Presidents and financial officers are expected to attend the annual Student Org Summit in September. This provides timely training to support organizations at the start of the new academic year. Most RSOs will be able to complete their minimum annual requirements at the Summit.

Student Organization Annual Spring Re-registration

Registered student organizations must submit a re-registration form annually through RevConnect. This process takes place in March or April of each year for the following academic year. For example, an RSO that is active during the 2026-2027 academic year will need to register in March/April 2027 in order to remain active for the 2027-2028 academic year.

During the re-registration process, RSOs will update their RevConnect profile, contact information, officers, and members; provide a current [constitution](#); and answer questions about their operations.

Failure to Complete Annual Requirements

RSOs that fail to complete the annual requirements will be placed on locked status with limited RSO privileges. Organizations must complete additional steps to regain full organization privileges.

Organizations that fail to fully address their locked status will be considered inactive and must complete the new student organization application process to be considered for reinstatement. In doing so, RSOs should be able to demonstrate how they will ensure compliance with annual requirements in the future. Organizations will shift from locked to deactivated after missing two consecutive compliance checkpoints (e.g., fall training, spring re-registration).

Organization Finances

IMPORTANT ORGANIZATION FINANCE NOTES

This section outlines the financial policies that govern registered student organizations. RSOs utilizing Student Government Association (SGA) funds should also refer to the Student Government Association Bylaws for additional budget guidelines.

With the diversity of RSO operations and needs, we cannot anticipate or document all financial situations that may arise. Carefully review the information below and reach out to Org Help with any questions prior to taking an action you are unsure about.

Organization Finances Overview

Presidents and financial officers are responsible for the ongoing monitoring and management of their financial accounts, including submitting payment requests, revenue deposits, and budget requests and resolving questions or concerns in a timely manner.

All RSOs are required to use the RevConnect platform and Org Help for financial management. Limited exceptions are noted throughout, and include:

- Graduate Opt-In Umbrella Organizations are responsible for re-allocating funds to their sub-organizations. Umbrella and sub-organizations may not submit RevConnect budget requests to the SGA for general allocations.
- Medical Center Student Council (MCSC) submits all RevConnect payment requests on behalf of affiliated sub-organizations using the MCSC RevConnect profile.
- Student Bar Association (SBA) and its affiliated sub-organizations coordinate all financial matters through the GW Law School.
- Club Sports officers work with their Campus Recreation Org Help representative to make payments and coordinate travel.

NOTE: Only financial officers and presidents may submit budget and payment requests on behalf of the organization.

Officers and advisors can access an RSO's financial accounts in [RevConnect](#). While all officers may view the various finance tools and accounts, only financial officers and presidents may submit budget and payment requests on behalf of the organization.

Plan ahead. Payment processes can take anywhere from three business days to six or more weeks depending on the nature of the payment and time of year.

Staff and faculty, including advisors, may not make purchases on behalf of an RSO unless they receive written permission from Org Help. It is important that all expenditures are accounted for in RevConnect.

Student Organization Finances Accounts

RSO Finance Accounts

Registered student organizations have access to two primary account types:

1. **Group Funds** (Revenue)
2. **Budgets** (SGA general allocations and co-sponsorships)

Some RSOs may also have a **Departmental or Club Sports account**. The [University-Wide Programs Fund](#) is also available for qualifying events.

Accounts are visible in the [Accounting Book](#) accessible from the RSO's RevConnect Dashboard. All funds in these accounts are considered university funds, and therefore, must be used in accordance with university policies and the university's tax-exempt status.

Group Funds (Revenue)

Group funds consist of all money raised by the RSO via dues, ticket sales, merchandise sales, donations, fundraising, etc.

- Group fund (revenue) account balances roll over from year to year.
- All credit/debit card payments and tax-deductible donations are deposited into group funds.
 - All credit/debit card payments, except incoming tax-deductible donations, must be deposited via RevConnect (preferred) or the Student Affairs [Credit Card Portal](#).
 - Student organizations should not accept payments into Venmo, Paypal or another unauthorized payment platform.
 - Charitable donations to the organization must be made through giving.gwu.edu to be considered tax-deductible. These funds are deposited once received from GW Advancement (at least quarterly).
- RSOs may not hold more than \$50,000 in their revenue account. RSOs with more than \$50,000 in their account as of July 2025 must work with their advisor to spend down those accounts before collecting additional funds, unless an exception is approved by the Division for Student Affairs.
- Group funds from an organization that remains inactive for four consecutive years will be reclaimed by the Division for Student Affairs.

Budgets (SGA General Allocations & Co-Sponsorships)

Budgets include money allocated to an RSOd from the Student Government Association (SGA).

- The SGA raises student body funds through the [SGA Fee](#) collected from all main campus students in on-campus programs each semester. The Division for Student Affairs also allocates a portion of the Student Activities fee to the SGA.
- RSO can receive SGA funds through two processes:

- **SGA General Allocations:** Most RSOs are eligible to receive a general allocation on an bi-annual basis (fall and spring semesters). General allocations for graduate opt-in organizations occur once per year.
- **SGA Co-Sponsorships:** RSOs may all request co-sponsorships throughout the academic year. Graduate opt-in umbrella organizations and their affiliated sub-organizations may not submit co-sponsorship requests unless an event is open to the entire student body (see SGA bylaws for more information).
- Both general allocations and co-sponsorship budget requests are [submitted through RevConnect](#), with the exception of graduate opt-in umbrella orgs and their sub-organizations.
- Budget funds must be spent in line with the line items submitted with the allocation request.
- Unused budget funds do NOT roll over to the next year.
- Fall funds must be used before the end of the fall semester and spring or full-year allocations must be used by the end academic year (typically December/January and mid-May, respectively). The SGA reserves the right to reclaim unused funds. Specific deadlines are communicated via email each year.

Departmental and Club Sports Accounts

Some RSOs may have departmental accounts or a Club Sports account. Money in these accounts are provided by a university department.

- Departmental accounts are set up and closely managed by the Org Help team in conjunction with the department serving as the funding source.
- Departmental and Club Sports accounts do NOT roll over from year to year.

University-Wide Programs Fund

The University-Wide Programs Fund (UWPF) provides financial support to registered student organizations, faculty, and staff for designated cultural and religious celebrations and campus traditions.

To ensure sustainability and clarity, the UWPF focuses on three core categories of university-wide programming, events, and services: Heritage and Affinity Celebrations, Religious, Spiritual, and Cultural Observances, and GW Traditions. Visit the [UWPF website](#) for more information.

External Bank Accounts

RSOs are not permitted to have external bank accounts or other financial accounts outside the university unless required by a national organization and approved in writing by the Division for Student Affairs. These exceptions are subject to an annual review and may be amended or revoked at any time for any reason by the Division for Student Affairs.

External parent organizations or alumni chapters that recognize an RSO may open and operate external accounts for the student organization's use; however, those accounts are the responsibility of the

external organization and may not be opened in the name of the university or GW student organization or use the university's tax identification number.

See the university's [Opening Bank Accounts policy](#) for more information.

General Student Org Financial Policies

Prohibited Purchases and Expenditures

Registered student organizations may NOT use university funds (group funds, budget, departmental, or club sports) for the following:

- Monetary prizes and awards and gift cards
- Unapproved travel or events (when advanced registration and approval is required)
- Reimbursement for use of a rideshare app (e.g., Uber, Lyft)
- Business or first class tickets or upgrades for flights or other travel
- Reimbursement of personal payment on a contract
- Payment to individuals via CashApp, Venmo, or PayPal (allowed for business PayPal accounts)
- Purchases of financial securities or cryptocurrencies
- Special occasion and graduate gifts for an individual (e.g., flowers, candy, balloons, fruit baskets); This does not include decorations for an event or items for fundraisers
- Drugs, tobacco products, firearms, ammunition
- Single-use plastics (e.g., styrofoam, plastic-lined paper products) that do not comply with the university's [single-use plastics policy](#)
- Reimbursement for campaign contributions or other political campaign activity spending
- A direct monetary or in-kind contribution to a candidate seeking elected office in an off-campus election
- Purchases connected to gambling
- Laboratory animals (must be ordered by the Animal Research Facility)

Neither payment requests nor reimbursements for items outlined above will be approved. Any exceptions are limited and require written approval by Org Help professional staff members or Division for Student Affairs leadership.

Contracts

Students and advisors are not authorized to sign contracts. Only designated GW staff members may sign contracts on behalf of the university. Individuals who sign contracts may be held personally liable for the agreement and financial obligations.

Contracts not processed through official GW channels will not be paid.

A payment request in [RevConnect](#) is required to make a payment on a contract. The RSO is responsible for submitting the payment request in a timely manner.

See [Contracts Overview](#) in the Events, Meetings, and Other Activities section for more information.

Donations

RSOs may donate funds to 501(c)3 nonprofit organizations from their group funds account. All donations must comply with the university's tax-exempt status and political activity policy.

- SGA funds may not be used for donations.
- Donations must be submitted through an RevConnect credit card payment request.
- The payment request must include a donation memo and a copy of the external organization's W-9 tax form (for domestic groups). The donation memo must include non-profit name, address, amount being given, and purpose for donation.
- Different documentation may be required for internationally-based non-profit organizations. Reach out to Org Help to discuss details.

For information on soliciting and accepting donations for your RSO, see [Donations and Fundraising](#).

Gift Cards

The purchasing of gift cards is prohibited.

Negative Accounts

Revenue and Departmental

- If a student organization's revenue account goes into the negative, the organization will receive notification and must meet with Org Help to develop a plan for repayment by the conclusion of the current academic year.
- No purchases will be approved until the account balance has been restored. If repayment is not made according to the agreed upon plan, the organization may be referred to Conflict Education and Student Accountability (CESA).

SGA Budgets

- If an organization's budget account goes into the negative, the SGA Legislative Budget Office (LBO) will notify the SGA Financial Services and Allocations Committee.
- If the organization's revenue isn't sufficient to cover the amount overspent, the organization must create a repayment plan.
- Until the repayment plan is created, the organization is ineligible to receive additional student body funds.
- For more information on negative balances in a Student Government Association account, consult the SGA bylaws.

Tax Exempt Status

All RSO should utilize the George Washington University's tax-exempt status when making organizational purchases with university funds (budget, group funds, and department funds).

If a vendor or entity requests your organization's tax ID number or W-9, simply provide them with GW's Tax ID number (53-0196584) and W-9 found on the [GW Tax Department website](#).

Vendor/Performer Registration

Vendors include individuals or companies that provide a service. Common examples of vendor types used by RSOs include guest speakers, DJs, musicians, photographers, caterers, and publishers.

- In order to receive payment for services provided via direct deposit or electronic wire payment, a vendor must complete a contract and be registered with the university via PaymentWorks.
- Vendor registration is not complete until the vendor receives an email confirming the registration as an active supplier with GW and providing the assigned GW supplier registration number.
- Org Help can support the organization in guiding vendors through the registration process.
- For more information on PaymentWorks or to register, visit the [Procurement New Supplier Registration website](#).

Sources of Funds

Student Government Association General Allocation

RSOs can apply for a general allocation through SGA Finance twice per year. Requests for fall funding can be submitted in the preceding spring semester, typically in March during the re-registration process. Requests for spring funding can be submitted in the preceding fall semester, typically in September or October. Money requested in the spring will be available no earlier than July 1 for the next academic year and are typically accessible starting late-July or August. Money requested in the fall semester will be available no earlier than January 2.

Mid-year Audit and Reclamations

RSOs that receive SGA funding may be required to submit an online form for the mid-year audit process. Failure to do so could result in deduction of available funds for the remainder of the year. The SGA facilitates this process. The mid-year audit takes place at the conclusion of the fall semester to re-claim surplus funds from events designated to occur in the fall. All SGA funds remaining at the end of spring semester are reclaimed.

Graduate Umbrella Student Organizations - Opt-In Process

[Graduate umbrella student organizations](#) that contain all the registered student organizations of a distinct graduate school may elect to receive a general allocation for the next fiscal year based on the previous academic year's enrollment. This is also known as "opt-in."

Graduate umbrella student organizations that opt-in are responsible for re-allocating student body funds to their constituent student organizations. As such, umbrella organizations and their affiliated sub-organizations may not submit an annual budget request to the SGA.

Alternatively, graduate umbrella student organizations can elect to receive a general allocation via the budget submissions process, in accordance with the SGA bylaws. If choosing to forgo the "opt-in" process, umbrella organizations must inform the Division for Student Affairs, SGA Legislative Budget Director, SGA Vice President, and their affiliated organizations prior to the opening of the SGA budget request process each year so individual organizations know to submit requests directly to the SGA.

Umbrella organizations will make their opt-in preference known to the Division for Student Affairs and Org Help teams during the annual registration period and are responsible for distributing funds to sub-organizations. The graduate umbrella student organization is responsible for submitting a report detailing the reallocation of student body funds to the respective constituent student organizations.

Graduate umbrella and sub-organizations are only eligible for SGA co-sponsorships if the funds will be used for an event or initiative open to the entire student body.

Financial Co-Sponsorships

An RSO can receive co-sponsorships from the SGA or from other RSOs. A financial co-sponsorship is a transfer of funding from one RSO to another RSO. A financial co-sponsorship typically does not involve a collaborative planning process; however, RSOs should discuss expectations during the request process.

Organizations providing a financial co-sponsorship to another RSO must complete a payment request via RevConnect for an org-to-org transfer.

In order to obtain an SGA co-sponsorship, student organizations must [submit a co-sponsorship budget request in RevConnect](#). Applications are reviewed by the SGA Financial Services and Allocations Committee and may require Senate approval depending on the request total.

Once the transfer has been completed, student organizations can utilize the funds through the standard payment request process.

Member Dues

RSOs are permitted to collect dues from their members. Dues should be paid via RevConnect credit card payments, cash, or check to the organization. RSOs may not use Venmo, CashApp, and similar mobile payment applications. These payment applications may have tax implications for the individual user.

Donations and Fundraising

Donations and Philanthropic Gifts to Student Organizations

Donations designated to specific RSO via [GW Giving](#), check, or GW-provided organization giving links will be reflected in the respective organization's Group Funds (Revenue) account in RevConnect.

Credit Cards: Individuals can use a credit card to donate to student organizations through the online Giving Portal, [GW Giving](#), operated by the Division of University Advancement. Within the Giving Portal, individuals can direct funds to a specific organization. Donations made through Advancement are tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law.

Checks: Donations can also be received via check. Checks should be made payable to the George Washington University and should note the designated purpose of the gift (student organization name) in the memo line. Check donations will be routed to the Division of University Advancement for appropriate recording and gift acknowledgement.

Giving Links: RSOs that collect donations on a regular basis can request an individualized “giving link” that will pre-populate the RSO’s name on the Giving Portal. Email orghelp@gwu.edu to request a link.

Note: Credit card payments received via RevConnect or the Student Affairs credit card portal will NOT be considered tax-deductible donations, nor will funds received via cash or mobile payment applications.

Utilizing the Division of University Advancement

The Division of University Advancement has tools and resources for student organizations to help fundraise and foster support for their cause.

- University Advancement can help groups share their message with the GW community and create a pipeline for budget-additive funding and donations year after year. There are many resources available for students to partner with the office to create clear and concise messaging, open communications to the larger GW community, and engage their audience through different social platforms.
- The Division of University Advancement facilitates various fundraisers that students and student organizations can participate in, including Student Organization Giving Challenge, Senior Class Gift, Buff and Blue Fund Challenge, and Giving Day. To become involved in any of the fundraisers, email giving@gwu.edu.
- University Advancement continues to connect current students with alumni to enrich the GW experience. Join [GW Career Connect](#) if your organization would like to connect with GW alumni to assist with professional or personal development or if your RSO would like assistance with fundraising initiatives. The Division is also able to assist with other fundraising projects or ideas.

Fundraising

Sales or solicitations by RSOs are viable fundraising opportunities. Organizations wishing to have off-campus vendors participate in an activity must include the name and type of vendor on space

reservation forms. GW student organizations may not partner with any business or individual who is primarily concerned with the sale, distribution, or promotion of alcohol or illegal drugs.

Profit Shares

To hold a fundraiser in conjunction with a local restaurant or food truck, also known as a profit share, RSOs should complete an Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) through Org Help. An MOU documents the details and financial arrangement of the event. This process should be completed before advertising for the event.

If your organization is partnering with a large national chain with a predetermined profit sharing system (e.g., Chipotle, Panera), you may be exempt from completing an MOU. Contact Org Help with questions.

To initiate the process, email the following information to orghelp@guw.edu.

- GW sponsoring student organization
- Student organization point of contact name, email, and phone number
- Name of vendor
- Vendor address
- Vendor point of contact name, title, email, and phone number
- Date and time of fundraising event
- Price student organization will pay to vendor (or indicate \$0 if applicable)
- Fundraising event description, include vendor provided service, the proceeds given to the student (e.g., 10% of total sales), and any conditions (e.g., minimum sales to qualify, requirements of purchaser to provide flyer)

Organizations may not sign MOUs. Allow 4 - 6 weeks for processing.

Fundraising for Charitable Organizations

RSOs may raise funds for nonprofit organizations. See [Donations](#) for more information.

Collecting and Depositing Funds

Collecting Funds Overview

There are five primary ways that funds can be deposited into an organization's account(s):

- Collecting credit card payment
- Collecting cash payments
- Collecting check payments
- Collecting GWorld payments
- Collecting a student organization or departmental transfer

Collecting and Depositing Credit Card Payments

- Most RSOs can accept credit card payments via RevConnect. (Green Line organizations should reach out to Org Help to discuss options.)
- Funds will be deposited into the designated organization's group funds account weekly.

Collecting and Depositing Cash

- Student organizations with cash on-hand from member dues or other fundraising activities must deposit it to their group funds (revenue) account via Org Help as soon as possible.
- Cash can be brought to the Org Help during office hours. Deposits will be reflected in the RSO's group funds account within a week of being received.

Collecting and Depositing Checks

- Check deposits will be credited to the RSO's group funds (revenue) account once verified by Org Help. The deposit is subject to reduction should a check be returned for insufficient funds.
- All checks must be written to "The George Washington University" and have the name of the student organization in the memo line.
- Checks may be brought to Org Help for deposit. If received via mail, checks may be sent to:
[STUDENT ORGANIZATION NAME]
ATTN: ORG HELP
800 21st Street NW, Suite 204
Washington, DC 20052

Collecting GWorld Payments

- Registered student organizations can rent a GWorld point of sale machine to collect GWorld funds for an event or fundraiser taking place in an approved reservable venue space on campus.
- All GWorld machines incur a 5% rental fee, which is deducted from the overall amount credited to the organization.
- Visit [the GWorld reader rental website](#) for more information.

Tax Considerations for Fundraising Sales

RSOs are responsible for DC sales tax on the sale of goods or merchandise (6%) and food (10%). Sales taxes will be withheld by Org Help when they are deposited into your RevConnect group funds account.

The term "sales tax included" must be added to sales language. For example, included on signs or in RevConnect stores when selling food or apparel.

Spending Organizational Funds

To spend money from your accounts, submit a RevConnect [payment request](#). Ensure that proper documentation is attached to each spending request.

Plan ahead. While most simple requests can be processed in about 3 business days, more complicated payments can take longer.

Tax-Exemption

When seeking tax exemption for purchases, inform the vendor your purchase is tax-exempt at the beginning of the interaction. If requested, provide the business with GW's W-9 Form or other state or local tax-exemption form. Keep in mind that rules vary by state, so not all purchases can be considered exempt from sales tax. All forms and additional information are available on the [Tax Exemption website](#).

Payment Requests

The policies and timelines associated with the different forms of payment vary, including what form of payment can be used for each good or service you are purchasing.

Below is a typical purchasing workflow:

1. Officer submits RevConnect payment request with appropriate documentation included
2. Org Help reviews request
3. Submitter notified of approval/denial or next steps if applicable
4. Org Help facilitates purchase or reimbursement

RSO finance officer(s) and president are responsible for monitoring payment requests and completing next steps or addressing questions in a timely manner. Reach out to Org Help with any issues or concerns about the progression of a payment request.

Submitting a Payment Request in RevConnect

To spend money from your account, submit a [payment request in RevConnect](#). **All purchases must be requested and approved in RevConnect.**

Separate payment requests are required if splitting a payment across multiple budgets (SGA general, SGA co-sponsorship, dept, etc.) or multiple line items within a budget.

Payment requests can be split across a budget account and group funds (revenue).

To initiate a payment request:

1. Navigate to your group's Dashboard > Accounting Book
2. Click the "Payment/Budget Request" button (located between on the right between your accounts and transactions)

3. Choose the appropriate source
4. Enter the requested information
 - a. From Allocated = enter amount to spend from a budget account
 - b. From Group Funds = enter amount to spend from group funds (revenue)

Request Status

Payment request status include: Pending Approval, Requires Modification, Approved, and Rejected. The status of a payment request can be found under the left menu under Activity Menu > My Surveys/Forms. The submitter will receive a notification from RevConnect when the status is updated. The submitter is responsible for monitoring the status.

Payment Methods

There are a variety of ways an RSO can spend its funds. Work with Org Help or your advisor to determine the most appropriate and effective purchase method.

University Credit Card / P-Card

If an RSO needs to purchase goods such as supplies or food, the RSO may utilize a GW credit card, also known as a P-Card, through Org Help.

- All credit card requests must be submitted through a RevConnect payment request.
 - Once the request has been marked as “Action Required - Make Appointment,” the organization will be prompted to make an appointment with Org Help to make the purchase.
 - Some credit card purchases, including those with Amazon wish lists, do not require an appointment. In these instances, the request will be marked as “Approved.”
- Advisors may not make P-Card purchases without the written approval of an Org Help professional staff member.
- Vendors must be able to accept telephone or online orders with no sales tax included in the purchase. [State-specific tax-exempt forms](#) can be found on GW’s website.
- Hotels, buses, caterers, etc. must have an invoice attached to the payment request for approval.
- All requests for food purchases must include marketing information for the event (social media post, email, or flier) or a guest list with first name, last name, and email of attendees.
- The organization is responsible for ensuring Org Help receives itemized receipts within three (3) business days of the transaction date. Should receipts not be submitted within this timeline, the organization may lose P-Card privileges.

Payment to Vendors via Direct Deposit

Any request for payment via check must be submitted with an invoice/contract attached. Contracts cannot be completed after services have been rendered.

- For vendor payments, the individual or company being paid must be properly registered with the university through PaymentWorks. Vendors must complete the [new vendor registration process](#) online before payment can be issued.
 - Note: This does not apply to GW staff or faculty.
- Vendors will be paid via direct deposit.
- The university's standard payment terms are NET 30 (i.e., 30 days from invoice date or date of services rendered/event, whichever is later).
- Payments can take up to six to eight weeks from request approval to being paid out. This process may move faster if everything is in order by the time the purchase request is submitted.
 - Payment cannot be initiated until after services have been fulfilled, unless stated otherwise in the contract and approved by GW Accounts Payable.
 - Vendors should be informed in advance about this timeframe.

Common causes for delayed payment include:

- Vendor is not registered in PaymentWorks before the payment request is submitted
- RevConnect payment request is not submitted in a timely manner
- RevConnect payment request does not include an invoice or contract

Invoices

Invoices are required for ACH/Check & Paypal (business) requests. Invoices provided by vendors should include the following to ensure they can be accepted by the university.

- Vendor name and address
- Student org name and GW address (800 21st NW, Washington, DC 20052)
- Invoice number
- Invoice date
- Invoice amount
- Details of items/services provided

Transfers

RSOs may need to make a payment to a GW department or another RSO for various reasons. This is done by submitting a RevConnect payment request for a transfer.

Student organizations can transfer funds the following ways:

- SGA Account to SGA Account*
- SGA Account to a University Departmental Account**
- Revenue Account to Revenue Account
- Revenue Account to University Departmental Account

RSOs may not transfer funds from an SGA budget account to a group funds (revenue) account or from departmental accounts to group funds accounts.

University departments should reach out to Org Help (orghelp@gwu.edu) with any questions.

**SGA Budget Account to SGA Budget Account transfers are only permitted for 1) SGA allocation to an organization, 2) SGA reclamation of unused funds, and 3) graduate opt-in umbrella organization reallocation to a sub-organization.*

***SGA Accounts to a University Department are limited to payment for services (e.g., venue fee) or co-sponsored events.*

GW Space Reservations, Facilities and Other Institutional Charges

- In conjunction with hosting an event, organizations may incur fees or charges for space usage, facilities, grounds, A/V tech support, University Police, or other auxiliary services.
- Upon notification of an institutional charge or fee that is listed on the event confirmation, the organization must submit a payment request for a transfer to that university department.
- If an organization fails to submit the payment request within 10 business days of notification, the amount will be automatically deducted from the organization's group funds or SGA account.
- Organizations are responsible for any amounts that bring their account into the negative as a result of booking space.

Reimbursements

Students may be reimbursed for RSO purchases of **no less than \$25 and no more than \$500** made with a personal form of payment. When possible, students should avoid reimbursements and make purchases with assistance from Org Help.

Requests for reimbursements must meet the following criteria. Any exception to the criteria below requires prior written approval from an Org Help professional staff member.

- Reimbursement requests must be submitted no later than 60 days from purchase date.
- All reimbursement requests must be accompanied by an itemized receipt. Bank statements will not be accepted in lieu of an itemized receipt. Itemized receipts must include the vendor's name, items purchased, purchase total, and payment method.
- For food purchases, an attendee list or marketing materials must be included with the receipts.
- The total amount must be equal to or less than the total shown on the receipt(s) provided.
- A student may not submit their own purchase request for reimbursement. An officer other than the individual being reimbursed must submit the payment request in RevConnect.

No reimbursement are provided for:

- Individual purchases greater than \$500
- Hotels, flights, train, bus, or rental cars (see [Domestic Travel Policy](#))
- Additional vehicle rental or travel insurance
- The purchase of apparel or merchandise that requires GW licensing approval (see [GW Brand Guidelines and Purchasing Merchandise](#))

- Any item in a violation of policy (e.g., Code of Conduct, Student Organization Handbook), including but not limited to prohibited items, payment to a vendor that required a contract, or purchase of gift cards

In order to be reimbursed, a student must complete their Expense Profile within the iBuy Concur system. The organization's officer who submits the reimbursement will be notified of the steps needed to complete the iBuy profile setup and must share this information with the individual needing reimbursement. Additional assistance can be provided by Org Help.

Mobile Payment Apps (e.g., Venmo, CashApp, Zelle)

With the exception of PayPal business accounts, **RSO are not permitted to make payments to an individual or vendor via mobile payment applications**, including, but not limited to, Venmo, CashApp, and Zelle. Requests to reimburse payments made by organization members via mobile payment applications will be denied.

RSOs are not permitted to utilize mobile payment applications or individual bank accounts for day-to-day business, or ongoing storage of organizational funds. Funds received through mobile payment applications are not considered tax deductible donations (see [Donations and Fundraising](#)).

There are no GW bank accounts that can be connected to these apps. An individual using their account attached to such an application is solely responsible for depositing funds to the organization and any IRS regulations or tax implications related to the use of such apps.

Preferred Vendors/iBuy

The university enters into special agreements with many suppliers who offer GW "best value" for its purchases. Organizations can take advantage of this when purchasing office supplies, furniture, computers, and more.

Preferred or best value vendors are [available via iBuy](#). An organization wishing to purchase from a vendor listed on iBuy should provide a list of items from the vendor website along with a credit card payment request in RevConnect. Org Help will facilitate the purchase.

Monthly Recurring Payments

In limited circumstances, RSOs may utilize a GW P-Card to pay for subscriptions (e.g., software, services, dues). As available, annual subscriptions or one-time payments are required instead of monthly.

If a recurring charge or monthly subscription is necessary (i.e., you cannot make a single annual payment), you must set up the recurring payment plan with Org Help. To do this, the organization's finance officer must:

- 1) Submit a new RevConnect payment request for each recurring charge

- 2) Send the receipt to Org Help via the payment request check after each payment is charged
- 3) Track the org's account balances to ensure adequate funds to cover all recurring expenses

If the cost of a recurring subscription increases beyond the amount of your initial request(s), you must submit a new purchase request.

Club Sports Finances

Overview

All Club Sports expenditures are managed through RevConnect payment requests. This includes Group Funds (revenue), SGA Budget allocations and co-sponsorships, and Club Sports/Campus Recreation departmental funds.

Making Purchases

- Clubs Sports follow the same procedures for submitted purchase requests.
- Transactions will be completed by a dedicated Org Help representative for Club Sports.
- Organizations will be provided with instructions on scheduling appointments to complete transactions with this representative.

Club Sports Council Additional Funds Requests

All additional funding requests for Club Sports departmental funds will be considered by the Club Sports Council. The Club Sports Council finance committee will meet every Tuesday evening to discuss requests and allocate funds.

All requests must be submitted by 8:00 PM on the Friday prior to the Tuesday meeting you would like to be considered. If you have any questions, please contact the Club Sports Council at gwclubsportsCouncil@gmail.com.

[Club Sports Additional Funds Request Form](#)

Member Dues Payable to Your Club

Club members can pay team dues through RevConnect using the membership fee feature or Stores. Review the guides below for more information.

- Membership fees - see [Group Settings](#) > Membership
- [Stores](#)

Events, Meetings, and Activities

RSO events are some of the most frequently attended and highly anticipated events at GW. There are a wide range of processes and policies applicable to organization events in order to ensure the safe and effective execution of a program.

Event Registration and Approval

Several event types require advanced registration and approval. An event that includes one or more of the following aspects must be submitted in [RevConnect](#) at least 2 weeks prior to the event date.

- Events with non-GW speakers, performers, or other activities requiring a contract
- Events with alcohol
- Events with minors as a primary audience
- Events open to non-GW community members
- Events with an expected attendance of 100+ individuals
- Domestic travel outside of the I-495 “Beltway”

For the above types of events, an RSO may not advertise or make purchases for an event until the registration is approved in RevConnect.

Individual RSOs may also be required to register certain events as part of a conduct action

Event Registration Process

- Submit an RevConnect event **at least 2 weeks prior** to the event.
 - Space should be requested prior to the RevConnect submission. A space reservation does not provide approval for the event itself.
- When applicable, Org Help will review the RevConnect event registration. Additional offices may review the request based on the nature of the event. The submitter may be asked for additional information to aid the review process.
- If approved, the RevConnect event will be marked as “Approved” and the event will appear on RevConnect. Visibility will depend on the audience selected on the event submission form.
- Event submissions may be “Returned for Modification” if additional information is needed.
- If denied, the RevConnect event will be marked as “Rejected” and the submitter will be notified.
 - Appeals may be submitted in writing to the Assistant Dean for Student Engagement within 5 business days of the rejection. The Assistant Dean’s decision is final and no further appeals will be permitted.

RSOs host a variety of activities and events that reflect their mission and shared interests. The approval of an organization’s event does not imply the university’s endorsement of the event purpose, guests, speakers, performers, or views expressed.

Guidelines for All Student Organization Events

The following policies and guidelines apply to all registered student organization events.

- Events must align with the purpose, mission, and goals of the host student organization(s).
- Hosts and attendees must abide by all university policies and venue guidelines.
- The reserved space must be used by the RSO that reserved it and for the purpose indicated on the reservation request.
- Events must end no later than midnight unless approved by the Division for Student Affairs. Additional requirements may be necessary for approval (e.g., GWPD).
- At least one representative of the RSO must be present throughout the duration of the event.
- Amplified sound may not be used without permission from the venue and cannot disrupt other university activities.
- RSOs must allow event and space access to venue staff and university officials acting in the course of their duties throughout the set-up, execution, and clean-up of an event.
- The host RSO(s) must have funds available to cover the cost of the event, if applicable.
- Organizations must clean up after the event in accordance with venue expectations.
- Organizations may not partner, co-host, or collaborate in any capacity on events with student organizations that are currently under the sanction of Suspension or Revocation of Registered Student Organization Status.

Contracts Overview

A contract must be completed whenever an RSO is engaging with a non-GW vendor and

- the event is on-campus,
- payment is being made for services,
- food delivery to campus is over \$1,000 (except with Org Help's EZCater or Uber Eats account), or
- the event is recorded or publicly distributed (e.g., Zoom event livestreamed on Facebook).

Common examples of when contracts are needed include:

- | | |
|---|---|
| • Performers, DJs | • Venue rentals |
| • Guest speakers, facilitators, coaches | • Photography, videography |
| • Catering | • Inflatables, photobooths, food trucks |
| • On-campus food delivery over \$1,000 | • Travel services |

If a performer is a GW employee, a contract is required if the individual is being paid for their services. GW students cannot be paid for services.

Note the following when preparing for an event or activity that requires a contract:

- **Allow up to 6 to 8 weeks** for a contract to be fully processed. A contract must be signed by the vendor or performer before it can be submitted for a GW signature.
- At a minimum, requests for contracts must be submitted 2 weeks prior to the event, although the university cannot guarantee turnaround in this timeframe.

- The contract process must be completed before advertising an event.
- Student organization representatives are not permitted to sign contracts as they are not legal representatives of the university.
- There is no pre-payment of contracts for services (i.e. no deposits).
 - Payment will be initiated upon completion of the event unless otherwise stipulated in the contract.
 - The university's standard payment terms are "NET 30" (30 days from invoice date); however, other terms may be negotiated by the university.
- There are no cash payments and payment cannot be made to a personal Venmo, CashApp, PayPal, or similar mobile banking apps.
- Vendors must register in GW PaymentWorks to receive payment.
- Payment on a contract can only be made as part of an RevConnect payment request.
 - Check payment on a contract can take 6 to 8 weeks from the event date.
 - Credit card payments can be remitted within 1 to 2 business days following the event.
 - Payments may be made using PayPal upon receipt of a detailed invoice attached to the RevConnect payment request. Payments can only be made to business accounts, not personal PayPal accounts.

Notice to Vendors: The George Washington University requires all vendors to have an approved written contract in place prior to providing goods or services. Entering into contracts verbally or without appropriate authority is prohibited. Any vendor who delivers services or goods to the university without a proper contract is doing so entirely at the vendor's own risk. The university does not pay for goods or services that were provided without the benefit of a properly approved and executed contract.

Types of Contracts

GW Templates

The Division for Student Affairs provides template contracts for RSOs, including:

- **Gratis Speaker Agreement** - Used for unpaid guest speakers
- **Contractor Agreement** - Used for paid guest speakers and other services, paid or unpaid

These contracts are generated by Org Help using the standard template and are reviewed and signed by the designated Division for Student Affairs leadership. If the speaker or contractor asks to change the standard language, additional reviewers will likely be required.

Vendor Provided Contracts

Vendors may also provide an organization with a contract - typically used for catering, venue rentals, and transportation services. These contracts are reviewed and signed by the Procurement Office.

Speakers and performers who work with a talent agency may also have a standard agency contract. Whenever possible, the GW template should be used as the primary document with the vendor contract attached as an addendum. These contracts are reviewed and signed by the designated Division for

Student Affairs leader, the Procurement Office, and/or the Office of General Counsel, depending on the nature of the agreement.

Steps to Processing a Contract

- 1. Organization determines the scope of services, including date, time, location, format, and cost.**
 - a. Consult with your Advisor or Org Help for event planning support.
 - b. We recommended including travel and accommodations expenses in the total cost.
 - c. While discussing logistics, please inform the vendor of the contract process and Certificate of Insurance (COI) requirements (see below) so that they are prepared for their next steps.
- 2. Organization submit a Contract Request Form in RevConnect** (linked in left menu). Attach the vendor provided contract, if applicable.
- 3. Organization submits an RevConnect event from their organization's profile.**
- 4. Upon receipt of the form, Org Help guides the rest of the process as follows:**
 - a. Org Help emails the vendor and include a copy of the contract, information on registering as a vendor, and COI requirements, if applicable. The student organization contact will be included on the correspondence.
 - b. The vendor reviews and signs the contract, registers as a vendor, and provides a COI if applicable. If the vendor requests changes, Org Help or Procurement will guide additional reviews and language updates, if approved.
 - c. When the vendor's signed contract is received, an authorized representative will sign on behalf of GW and share the fully executed contract with the vendor.
- 5. If applicable, the organization submits a RevConnect payment request.**

The RevConnect event submission will be approved and the organization may begin advertising the event once the contract has been fully executed.

SBA and MCSC Umbrella Organizations and Sub-organization

In line with financial procedures, Student Bar Association and SBA sub-organizations will coordinate contracts through the Law School. Medical Center Student Council and MCSC sub-organization should work with MCSC to coordinate contracts through the primary MCSC RevConnect account.

Certificate of Insurance (COI)

A Certificate of Insurance (COI) is required for on-campus caterers, paid speakers, performers, and other vendors. The coverage required will be outlined in the GW contract, including resources for obtaining coverage if needed. The George Washington University should be named as an additional insurer for general liability coverage and certificate holder as:

The George Washington University
Risk Management

Inviting GW Executive Leadership to Events

RSOs that want to invite President Granberg, Provost Balleisen, or Vice President Coleman should first inform their advisor (or Org Help for Silver and Yellow Lines) of the request. The advisor or Org Help will email details to the Division for Student Affairs (dsa@gwu.edu) for consideration.

If an event request is approved, briefing templates and related instructions will be provided to student organization leaders and advisors.

Requests submitted fewer than four weeks before an event may be considered on a case-by-case basis; however, requests submitted within one week of an event will not be considered.

Photos and Video Recording at Events

RSOs reserve the right to photograph and/or video record their events and activities or use in marketing and communications materials, websites, social media, etc. Photos and videos taken at organization sponsored events may capture images of event attendees (e.g., students, staff, faculty, visitors).

Organizations should consider the following in regards to an individual's privacy:

Give Notice

Event organizers should notify event attendees that photography or filming is taking place ahead of or during the event. Common notification methods include details on the event registration, written notice posted at the event, or a verbal announcement.

Consider adding the following notice to your RevConnect event description:

Photos and/or videos of attendees of this event may be taken and shared on social media, websites, or marketing materials. Please contact the event organizer if you have questions about photography or recordings at this event.

Obtain Consent

Generally, it is not necessary to obtain explicit consent from individuals photographed or videotaped at student organization events, especially in public spaces and venues, or attending public events, for wide shots that are not focusing on specific individuals, and where no-one is clearly identifiable in the photograph or clip.

If, however, an individual is photographed and/or videotaped and is easily recognizable in the photograph or video, the organization should consider obtaining permission from the individual if the photograph or video will be distributed or published outside internal organization communications.

Special considerations should be given to images of minors who are not enrolled at GW where parental/legal guardian written release may be required, if the photo is only of one or a few children, as compared to a very large crowd.

Provide Your Contact Information

Organizations should include contact information so that individuals can reach out should they have questions or concerns about the use of photography or video recording at your event.

Ticket Sales

If selling tickets for an event, student organizations should utilize the RevConnect event ticket credit card payment option, GWorld reader, or cash/check.

- **RevConnect Tickets (credit card payments)** - Org Help will deposit funds into Group Funds (revenue) accounts weekly.
- **GWorld Reader** - RSOs can rent a GWorld reader to collect GWorld funds for an event in an approved reservable space on campus. A 5% rental fee will be deducted from the overall amount credited to the RSO. For more information visit the [GWorld FAQ website](#).

Lisner Auditorium

Beginning Fall 2025, events held in Lisner Auditorium must use the University's Box Office and official online ticketing platform to sell any and all advance and walk-up tickets. Tickets shall be subject to per-ticket and per-order non-refundable service charges and/or handling fees. Learn more on the [specialty venues website](#).

Organizations must submit a RevConnect payment request “transfer” to the appropriate department and attach the event confirmation that lists the associated cost.

Eventbrite and Non-GW Platforms

RSOs should avoid Eventbrite, Venmo, and similar external platforms for ticket sales. These platforms require funds to be deposited into a personal bank account. The Division for Student Affairs does not accept these payouts. Any individual who uses their bank account for this purpose is personally responsible for related IRS requirements and tax implications.

Free Expression Activities

The university is committed to equal access, free inquiry, free expression, and vigorous discussion and debate. Demonstrations and other free expression activities must comply with all applicable laws and university policies.

GW maintains the right to define the time, place and manner, and objects used during demonstrations occurring on any university-owned or leased property and during events or activities hosted by the university, whether on-campus, off-campus, or virtually.

All students should familiarize themselves with the relevant university policies and community guidance and procedures, including:

- [Free Expression at GW website](#)
- [Demonstrations Policy](#) and the related [GW Community Guidance and Procedures for Demonstrations](#)
- [Poster Policy](#)
- [Equal Opportunity, Nondiscrimination, Anti-Harassment, and Non-Retaliation Policy](#)

No one group or organization holds a monopoly on dissent or on freedom to hear all sides. Further, the fact that students may pursue their interests through speech and assembly at the university does not abrogate their accountability as citizens to the laws of the larger society, and the university is entitled to reflect these constraints in its own regulations.

Organizations planning a protest, demonstration, or other free expression activities are encouraged to consult their Advisor, the Division for Student Affairs Student Involvement team, and/or Conflict Education and Student Accountability (CESA).

Showing TV Shows, Movies, & Other Films

Films and movies can only be played publicly with a proper license. Generally, no film or movie rental, purchase, or stream (e.g., Netflix) carries the right to exhibit it outside an individual's home. Student organization events do not typically qualify for an education exception which are reserved for face-to-face teaching activities in a classroom or similar setting.

To show a film as a public performance, an RSO must purchase a Public Performance License for each instance they want to show a film/movie. This can be done by contacting one of the following agencies that handle public performance licenses. If a license is not available through these agencies, the organization will need to contact the film/movie creator to obtain license purchasing information.

- [Swank Motion Pictures, Inc.](#)
- [Criterion Pictures USA](#)
- [Motion Pictures Licensing Corp.](#)

Outdoor movies may only occur between March 21st and October 31st and are not permitted to be shown if the rating is R, MA, or beyond.

Hosting an Event with Amplified Sound

Events with amplified sound are subject to the rules and policies of the space in which the event is taking place. When scheduling programs with amplified sound, RSOs must keep in mind the impact that

amplified sound will have on campus and the surrounding communities. If you are planning an outdoor event with sound, your organization must indicate as such on the outdoor space request form and obtain approval from the Student Center team. GW reserves the right to deny or limit programs that may pose a significant disturbance to the campus community, university operations, or surrounding neighborhood.

Indoor Events

- Academic buildings do not allow for any amplified sound or loud activities as this may disrupt classes taking place.
- Amplified sound is allowed in all event spaces in the University Student Center and requires approval through the room reservation process. Organizations will work with their assigned university event planner to ensure their event does not impact other events happening at the same time within the building.

Outdoor Events

- Noise levels should not exceed 80 decibels in the nearest building unless pre-approved by the Division for Student Affairs.
- Amplified sound will not be permitted before 9:00 a.m. or after 10:00 p.m. Amplified sound outdoors will not be permitted during university-designated reading days and final exam periods.

Hosting an Event with Food

- RSOs may use a catering service of their choice for on-campus events. Catering for off-campus events is subject to the rules of the venue.
- When planning a menu, consider varying food preferences, allergies, intolerances, or restrictions. Do your best to accommodate as many people as possible, including inquiring in advance about any dietary restrictions or concerns.
- Food deliveries to campus that are over \$1,000 require a contract, unless processed through Org Help's EzCater or UberEats accounts. Consult Org Help for specifics.
- Contracts, however, are required by many catering services used for more complex food service or delivery.
 - On-campus venues also require a copy of the caterer's business license and certificate of liability insurance (COI).
 - Follow the [contract process](#) and forward all contracts to Org Help. If you have an assigned Staff Advisor, copy them on the email for their awareness.
- RSOs may request UberEats Vouchers through a RevConnect payment request. The voucher will be added to an individual's personal UberEats account and the amount used will be charged to the organization. Unused portions of the voucher will expire and cannot be repurposed.
- Review the [single-use plastics policy](#) to ensure compliance when purchasing materials or ordering catering.
- Note that the time needed for catering set-up and breakdown must fall within the event time.

- Food and beverage is not permitted in academic spaces, Betts Theater, Mitchell Theater, and District House B132. Consult the venue manager for any additional policies or restrictions.
- RSOs may bring food and beverages into other Student Center spaces, but are responsible for cleanup. This includes disposing of all trash in designated receptacles. If a group leaves the space with excess mess or garbage, they may be charged for housekeeping fees.
- Food safety standards should always be a top concern for your organization. Make sure that food is served in a hygienic environment, including using food-grade gloves.
- If your organization is preparing food for others, ensure that the space in which food is prepared is clean and hygienic, the materials used are fresh, and the people cooking or baking are safely handling the food.
- If your event is in a public space or uses the street (e.g., food trucks), you may need to secure permits or reserved parking from the District of Columbia. Talk to your Advisor or Org Help to see if your event will require a permit.

Hosting a Fundraising Event

Registered student organizations may solicit funds for organization-sponsored initiatives or with the intent to donate to an external charitable organization. See [Finances - Donations](#).

RSOs may not partner with any business or individual who is primarily concerned with the sale, distribution, or promotion of alcohol or illegal drugs.

Coordinating university fundraising with the fundraising for any candidate for public office, political party, PAC, or any similar politically active organization is prohibited. See [Expectations, Policies, and Accountability - Political Campaign Activities](#).

Organizations wishing to host or utilize off-campus vendors in an on-campus fundraising activity must include the name and type of vendor on space reservation forms (e.g., selling Krispy Kreme donuts). Sales and/or solicitation on campus are permitted only when the organization has received the approval of the venue in which sales/solicitation would occur.

Any funds raised must be deposited into the student organization's Group Funds (revenue) account.

RSOS may also partner with vendors to host fundraising events off-campus or with an on-campus food venue. See [Finances - Profit Shares](#).

For all events where attendance will be controlled through ticketing or registration, there are a variety of internal registration platforms as well as various payment methods to consider. To better understand the different means of selling tickets. See [Finances - Collecting and Depositing Funds](#).

Hosting an Event with Minors

In the course of organizational activities, RSO officers and members may interact with minors, defined as any individual under the age of 18. This may include newly matriculated GW students or non-GW individuals participating in RSO programs (e.g., mentoring, tutoring, outreach programs, conferences).

The following guidelines and the [GW Protection of Minors](#) policy are in place to ensure the safety and well-being of minors involved in student organization-affiliated programs and events.

All programs and events that include non-GW minors as the primary audience must be registered through RevConnect at least two (2) weeks prior to the event. Additional requirements, such as a participant waiver, may be required based on the nature of the event or activity.

The following guidelines are offered as a complement to the [GW Protection of Minors](#) policy and are in place to ensure the safety and well-being of minors involved in RSO-related programs and activities.

- All persons must make all reasonable efforts to remove minors from dangerous or potentially dangerous situations
- Programs and activities involving minors on campus, off campus, or virtual, must be registered with and approved by the university
- One-on-one physical encounters and one-on-one electronic communication between GW students and participating minors is prohibited
- If there is a legitimate, program-related reason for communication to occur, contact must be limited to topics related to the sanctioned activities and include the minor's parent/guardian, external program sponsor (e.g., school liaison), or official GW organization email account
- GW students must involve a third party (delegation chaperone/advisor or university administrator) as part of the conversation when/if electronic communications are occurring with non-GW minors.
- Private electronic communication between GW students and minors is prohibited. This includes the use of personal social networking sites such as Tiktok, Facebook, Instagram, X (formerly known as Twitter), and Snapchat; instant messaging; and texting. GW students should not "friend," "follow," etc. minors on social networking sites, communicate via internet chat rooms, send personal emails or text messages.
- It is essential to maintain clear professional boundaries and avoid sharing personal or intimate information including personal life details, intimate experiences, financial information, health issues, contact information, and personal beliefs on sensitive topics.
- If using a digital communication platform, all participants must log in and be on camera throughout the duration of the activity. The use of still photos or a blank screen is prohibited.

Every member of the university community who knows, suspects, or receives information indicating that a minor has been or is being abused or neglected must report this information to the university. Reports may be made to the Office of Ethics, Compliance, and Risk via email at comply@gwu.edu. Organizations should also inform their Advisor or Org Help.

Insurance, Waivers, and Planning Events with Risky Activities

Organizations wishing to hire an entertainment vendor (production companies, inflatables, novelties, games, etc.) must work with companies GW has approved through the Office of Risk Management. A list of pre-approved vendors can be found on the [Office of Risk Management website](#); should your

organization wish to utilize a vendor that has not been pre-approved, consult with Org Help to seek review and approval.

Events with physical activities or other activities deemed to have an elevated level of risk may require participants to sign a waiver prior to participation. Consult with Org Help to determine whether a waiver will be required. Template waivers can be attached to a RevConnect event and signed electronically by participants upon event registration.

Organizations for which risky activities are centric to the mission and purpose (rock climbing, club sports, hiking, etc.) may be asked to submit a risk management plan for review and approval by the university.

Events Requiring University Police

Some events may require the presence of George Washington University Police Department (GWPD) officers due to the size or nature of the event. Events that require GWPD presence or involvement include the following:

- Late Night Party (Fraternity and Sorority Life organizations)
- Events taking place in on-campus buildings outside of the building operating hours

GWPD may also be required at other events as deemed necessary by university officials. This may include events with high-profile speakers, concerts, events with large crowds, or events with the potential for (counter)protest.

In line with its mission to prioritize student and community safety, the university reserves the right to evaluate and determine the need for GWPD at on-campus events. The host organization is responsible for costs associated with GWPD presence. Financial support for these costs may be available from the Student Government Association via a co-sponsorship.

GWPD must be scheduled to arrive one hour prior to the event start time and one hour after the event concludes with a four hour minimum. GWPD also reserves final rights to determine the need and number of officers staffed for the event.

Organizations are responsible for scheduling GWPD for events. For more information or to request GWPD for an event, visit the [University Police website](#).

Hosting an Event with Outside Sponsorship and/or External Organizations

Organizations are permitted to partner with external organizations for individual program support, financial support, or more permanent organizational affiliation. RSOs are not permitted to partner with any sponsors or external organizations who primarily promote, distribute, or sell alcohol or illegal drugs. If you are unsure if you should partner with a business or organization, reach out to Org Help to see if a partnership would be appropriate.

When an event is hosted by the RSO in partnership with an external organization, the name of the external organization may be included, but the RSO name must also be included. In doing so, the RSO name must be the most prominent in size and placement on all signage, promotions, and associated materials. RSOs are responsible for scheduling, planning, and executing an event held in campus space, as well as for ensuring RSO leaders are present for the duration of the event. External organizations that utilize the space for their own events will be charged as an external client for a sponsored event.

Events that involve outside partners or external organizations as a primary planner, facilitator, and/or attendees of an event may be deemed as “sponsored.” An event that is considered “sponsored” may be subject to room rental and set up charges. RSOs retain full responsibility for their events. Outside sponsors and external entities shall not direct, coerce, or otherwise exert undue influence over an organization’s or individual student’s activities and conduct.

For further information on sponsored events, contact Org Help or the manager(s) of the venue for related policies.

Hosting an Event with a Raffle or Charitable Game

If you choose to host a raffle or charitable game at, or as an event, you are required by District of Columbia law to obtain a permit. The raffle permit can be found at the [DC Fundraising and Charitable Games website](#). RSOs interested in obtaining a permit should consult their advisor or Org Help as early as possible.

The District of Columbia laws define the term “raffle” as one or more drawings from a single series of chances sold by means of chance tickets. Guidelines for raffles include the following:

- All proceeds from raffles must go directly to the RSO or the designated charitable organization.
- Only currently registered members of the RSO or employees of the university may conduct, manage and operate raffles on campus.
- The District of Columbia requires a permit for conducting a raffle. A copy of the permit must be submitted to your Advisor or Org Help and the appropriate scheduling office.
- Application and support documents must be submitted to the D.C. Charitable Games Commission at least 30 business days prior to the event. The RSO is responsible for completing and submitting the application and should do so in consultation with their Advisor or Org Help.
- Alcohol may not be raffled off by student organizations.

Prize drawings are permitted as long as individuals do not have to pay to have the chance to win.

Single-Use Plastics Policy

The university has committed to eliminating all single-use plastics at GW. This commitment includes all non-essential, non-compostable, single-use plastics with available alternatives.

Single-use plastic items should not be purchased using organization funds where alternatives are available. Purchases of single-use plastics are also excluded from university reimbursement.

Review the full [Single-Use Plastics Policy](#) for definitions and more specifics about what can and cannot be purchased with organizational funds.

Additional resources:

- [GW Single-use Plastics Elimination Guide](#)
- [GW Green Event and Catering Guide](#)
- [GW Green Office Network](#)

Events with Alcohol

EVENTS WITH ALCOHOL POLICY SUMMARY

A proposed student organization-sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages will be consumed, served, or sold must be submitted in RevConnect at least two (2) weeks in advance of the event date for review and approval by the Division for Student Affairs or designee.

Only Red, Blue, and grad-only Orange Line (grad-only) organizations with risk managers who completed the required training are eligible to host events with alcohol. The distribution of alcohol must be done through a ticketed system or cash bar. Open bars and “BYOB” events are not permitted.

See [Appendix 1 for Events with Alcohol Policy](#)

Booking Space On Campus

Booking Space Overview

As an urban campus, finding available space can be a challenge. The university has several different offices that manage spaces on campus, with distinct reservation processes and policies. For an overview of most available spaces on campus and how to book, view this [GW Venues overview](#).

- An advance reservation is required to utilize most spaces on campus. Space reservations are distinct from posting the event on RevConnect. An approved RevConnect event does not represent or result in a reserved space.
- Organizations are responsible for scheduling, planning, and executing an event held in campus space. External organizations that utilize the space for their own events will be charged as an external client. When a recognized student organization hosts an external (non-GW) organization (regardless of profit, non-profit, or faculty/staff association with academic societies) for an event, this is considered a “Sponsored event” and space rental fees will apply.
- The RSO booking a space must ensure that the space is used exclusively for the purpose and organization indicated during the booking process. If the space is used by a different group or for a different purpose, the organizations risk their privilege to reserve venues in the future. Student organizations who violate this policy may also be held responsible via the [Code of Student Conduct’s](#) policy on Dishonesty and Misrepresentation.
- ROS may not impede on the rights of any other organization or entity, whether internal or external to the university, to use space which has been properly reserved. See [Free Expression at GW](#) and the [Demonstrations Policy](#) for more information.
- RSOs are not permitted to place overnight structures of any sort on Kogan Plaza due to the amount of space required and the high-traffic nature of that particular community-wide space.

How to Book Spaces on Campus

Only officers of an RSO, as designated in RevConnect, may book space for their organization.

Meeting Rooms, Major Space, and Outdoor Space

[GW Venues](#), within the Division for Safety and Operations, manages the scheduling for the following spaces:

- University Student Center (800 21st St. NW)
- Outdoor space (Kogan Plaza, University Yard, Square 80, Potomac Square, Anniversary Park, G St. Park, and the outdoor classroom space)
- District House
- Mitchell Multipurpose Room

- Mount Vernon Campus Event Spaces (Hand Chapel, Post Hall, Pelham Commons, Eckles Auditorium, West Hall meeting rooms, Ames study rooms, Ames Skyboxes and the Quad)
- State Room & City View Room (1957 E Street NW)
- Jack Morton Auditorium
- Lisner Auditorium

HOW TO BOOK: For all spaces above, visit the [GW Venues website](#). Find and select the space that best suits your needs in the “Student Portal” at the bottom of the page. You will then be taken to the reservation system via Single Sign-On. The GW Venues team will confirm your reservation or reach out for more information.

Booking for these spaces opens 365 days in advance. Major spaces, such as State Room, City View Room, Jack Morton Auditorium, and Lisner Auditorium require at least a 30 day advance booking.

RSO events may have costs associated with them (e.g., production, A/V). To view the university price lists and estimates, log into the [University Box folder](#).

For more information, visit the [GW Venues website](#).

Lerner Health & Wellness Center

For Lerner Health & Wellness Center reservations, visit the [Campus Recreation facilities website](#) or email recreation@gwu.edu.

Athletics

GW Athletics manages the following space:

- Smith Center
- Mount Vernon athletic fields, tennis courts

HOW TO BOOK: Email athsched@gwu.edu to inquire about availability.

For more information visit the [Athletics facilities website](#).

Classrooms (Academic Scheduling)

Academic Scheduling, within the Office of the Registrar, manages classroom and lecture spaces in academic buildings. The best uses of academic space are for simple meetings, discussions, and lectures. Food is not permitted in classroom spaces. Take a moment to review [policies](#) related to reserving classroom space on campus as there are restrictions on what an RSO can do within academic space.

HOW TO BOOK: Submit a request through the Office of the Registrar [online reservation request form](#). Review the [Reservations & Rental Procedures website](#) for additional guidance.

If you need assistance or for more information, visit the [Office of Registrar](#) website or email sched@gwu.edu.

Student Theater Council

Organizations belonging to the Student Theater Council (STC) are able to request campus performance space through STC. This process is outlined by STC and its leadership with the organizations who may utilize affiliated spaces (i.e., Lisner Downstage, Mount Vernon Black Box). If you would like to use either of these two spaces and are not currently in the STC, you may contact the STC leadership to check the availability at stc@gwu.edu.

Other GW Spaces (Law School, Medical School, etc.)

Some campus locations may have restricted access or reserve space for their affiliated students, faculty, and staff. Visit the individual school or venue website for more information.

Cancellation of Space

Different spaces have different policies in regard to canceling space. As a rule of thumb, your organization is responsible for canceling space if you know you are not going to be using it. Please be considerate of other RSOs and campus partners who may be looking for space with limited availability.

You may inquire about cancellation policies for other spaces by contacting the managers of those spaces directly. Most space managers ask that you cancel reservations when you know you will no longer use it. Repeatedly booking space without using it may result in losing your RSO's privilege to book space.

Organization Storage and Office Space

Overview

Storage and office space on campus is very limited. RSO offices are located on the fourth floor of the University Student Center (USC). Storage lockers are located in the USC, Shenkman Hall, and South Hall.

Assignments are made on an annual basis and previous assignment of storage space does not guarantee future assignment. Changes to storage assignments may be made by the Division for Student Affairs at any time for any reason. Eligibility for storage and office space is based upon [Pathways](#).

Access to the space is contingent upon the organization being in good standing and compliance with USC Policies, university and registered student organizations policies, and the guidelines below.

Storage Lockers

Regular checks will be conducted to ensure compliance with the guidelines below. RSOs found in violation must remedy any violations in a timely manner or be subject to increased warnings or revocation of locker assignment.

By accepting the locker assignment, your organization agrees to the following terms:

- Storage is only to be used for items belonging to the student organization assigned to the locker.
- Items may only be stored in assigned lockers - all other lockers and common areas may only be used with the expressed written permission of the Division for Student Affairs.
- No perishable items (including snacks and candy), alcohol, drugs, illicit paraphernalia, weapons, fireworks, flammable materials, or other prohibited items. Discovery of these items may result in immediate removal of the group from their storage space, in addition to potential university sanctions against the organization and/or individual members.
- The Division for Student Affairs reserves the right to remove any items from the storage lockers at any time.
- The Division for Student Affairs is not responsible for loss, theft, or damage of any items stored in the lockers. All storage is kept in the location at the student organization's own risk.
- Organizations must reapply for storage annually. A current assignment of space does not guarantee a future assignment. Failure to reapply will result in the organization losing their assigned space. Organizations will be given notice to remove their belongings. If belongings are not removed they will be disposed of.
- Each organization will be assigned one lock per assigned locker. Only the assigned locks may be used within the storage room space. Personal locks will be removed.
- Loss of a lock will result in the RSO being charged for the cost of a new lock (~\$10-\$20).

Organization Offices

Some RSOs have access to USC office space, which is very limited. Regular checks will be conducted to ensure compliance with these terms of use. Organizations found in violation must remedy any violations in a timely manner or be subject to increased warnings or revocation of space assignment.

Use/Purpose

Student Organization office space is provided to foster opportunities for student organizations to conduct student organization business.

- Storage may not be the primary use of an office space.
- Examples of unauthorized use of space include parties, socials, and personal item storage.
- Office space may only be used by the RSO to which it is assigned. RSOs are not permitted to share any allocated space with other RSOs, unrecognized groups, external organizations, etc.

Storing food items in office spaces should be limited to prevent pests.

- Food items must be stored in sealed containers. Any sealed food stored in offices must be removed before the expiration date.
- Any food which is consumed in your office by organization leaders during office hours must be disposed of in waste bins outside of your office space to prevent pests.

Prohibited items to store in office space include:

- Paint cans
- Spray paint
- Sterno ("canned heat")
- Compressed gasses (e.g., helium, propane)
- Flammable items
- High-consumption electrical appliances (e.g., microwaves, refrigerators, hotplates)
- Acrylic poster paint is permitted, however, is not to be used within the office space.

Prohibited items will be confiscated and disposed of if found. Org Help will notify organization officers and advisors, if applicable, of a violation. Continued violations are subject to sanctions, up to and including the removal of office space, at the discretion of the Division for Student Affairs.

Housekeeping and Cleanliness

- Assigned office spaces must be kept clean and organized.
- GW manages a Housekeeping Staff which maintains the cleanliness and general appearance of the University Student Center.
 - Desks will only be dusted if they are prepared (i.e. desks must be cleared off).
 - Trash and recycling bins may not be emptied on a daily basis. Perishable trash should be placed in common area receptacles located in hallways.
 - Vacuuming of organization office spaces is available upon request.
 - Contact the University Student Center to inquire about other custodial needs.

- Random walkthroughs will be conducted to assess the usage and cleanliness of office spaces.
- Should your space be found to be unsatisfactory, your e-board and Staff Advisor will be notified.
- Organizations that are found to consistently violate terms of use and do not rectify the issues may be charged a \$100 surcharge for cleaning and will be prohibited from applying for office space for the following academic year. No appeals will be accepted.

Office Hours

- Organizations must commit to a minimum of ten (10) office hours per week while classes are in session during the academic year.
- Office hours must be clearly displayed on the door of the office space for the duration of the academic year.
- At any time the office hours change, please ensure they are updated as soon as reasonably possible. Office hours should also be included on your organization's RevConnect page as an ongoing event for the duration of the academic year.
- Any organization that repeatedly fails to meet the minimum requirement may have their office space revoked for the remainder of the academic year and may not be eligible to receive office space the upcoming academic year.

Reporting facilities problems

- Requests for repairs should be submitted through the [FixIt system](#).
- RSOs are responsible for reporting any facilities or furniture issues that occur during their use of the office, including damage to the physical infrastructure and broken/unstable desks or chairs.

Office Setup

- Signs, pictures, and posters may only be taped on walls, doors, and desks using painter's tape.
- Organizations may not otherwise hang, affix, or tape items to interior office walls, other surfaces, or outside their office except for designated areas (e.g., bulletin boards, glass cases).
- No items may be hung on windows.
- Temporary items may not be tacked or nailed to walls or doors.
- Organization may incur the cost to repair damages caused by hanging items on walls or doors.

Personal Conduct

- Possession and consumption of alcoholic beverages are prohibited within the University Student Center. Smoking and other use of tobacco is prohibited at all times within all areas of the University Student Center.

Access

- Office space will be available during USC hours of operation. University Student Center staff may adjust hours of operation based on the level of activity within the facility, as well as during special events and university breaks. On most occasions, the building will close at midnight during the academic year.
- RSO officers are the only members of the RSO that should have access to your office space.
- No Division for Student Affairs staff will open offices for individual members who do not have the code to the office. Each RSO is individually responsible for coordinating access to members.
- The university is not responsible for stolen or missing items from your office space due to misuse of office access. We encourage all RSOs to refrain from storing valuable items in offices.
- Access codes to each individual office will be changed on an annual basis before the beginning of the Fall semester.

Liability

- The university, the Division for Student Affairs, or any official university subsidiary shall not be held responsible for any loss or theft of property from an office.
- The university is not responsible for any damages that may occur within the office. Student organizations are responsible for the repair of any damage beyond normal usage.

End of Year

- It is understood that an assignment is for the duration of an academic year, concluding at the end of Spring classes.
 - Staff will notify RSO leaders whether their assignment will continue for the next academic year, whether they will be reassigned, or whether they will need to vacate the office space.
 - Any organizations who are asked to move their belongings and fail to are subject to cleaning fees to dispose of left-behind items.
-

Organization Travel

ORG TRAVEL POLICY SUMMARY

- Any individual or group traveling on behalf of a student organization must register and receive approval for travel. Domestic and International travel have different guidelines and timelines. The Code of Student Conduct applies both on- and off-campus.
- All hotel rooms, vehicle rentals, tickets, etc. must be purchased in advance through RevConnect and the Org Help team. Only authorized registered drivers are approved to drive rental vehicles.
- Club Sports teams should refer to the “Club Sports - Additional Information” section of the Handbook for more details about differences in Club Sports travel policies and procedures.

Domestic Travel

Domestic travel outside of the Washington, D.C. metro area, defined as outside the I-495 “Beltway,” must be registered with and approved by the Division for Student Affairs through a Revconnect event registration. **Registrations must be submitted at least two (2) weeks prior to departure.**

- Unregistered and unapproved trip expenses will not be reimbursed and put the organization’s benefits and registration status at risk.
- Every event registration must include the template waiver. Each participant must RSVP to the event and electronically sign the attached waiver.
- Travel and hotel accommodations are booked in RevConnect as part of a purchase request.

Club Sports teams should refer to the “Club Sports - Additional Information” section of the Handbook for differences in Club Sports travel procedures, including registering travel via the DSE platform.

Student Bar Association and affiliated sub-organizations will work with GW Law School to coordinate travel reservations and payments.

Medical Center Student Council and affiliated sub-organizations must coordinate travel and payments using the primary MCSC RevConnect account.

Driving

Below is a summary of the GW Vehicle Safety Policy as it relates to registered student organizations. Drivers and passengers traveling with or on behalf of a student organization should review the [Vehicle Safety Policy](#) in full.

Regardless of vehicle type (rental, GW Fleet, or personal), student drivers driving for RSO travel must abide by the mileage and time limits noted below.

- Any student or staff member driving a rental or GW Fleet vehicle on behalf of a student organization must be an authorized driver.

- All prospective drivers must have a current and valid driver's license from a U.S. state or territory.
- Drivers must agree to operate vehicles in accordance with local, state and federal laws, as well as university policies and guidance.
- Seat belts must be worn by drivers and passengers at all times
- Individual student drivers should not travel more than 320 miles, or roughly 6.5 hours in a single day. Breaks should be taken to pause continuous driving at 200 miles or roughly after 3 hours of driving.
- No travel should occur after 11:00 pm or before 5:00 am local time.
- Reasonable extensions and special considerations (e.g., estimated travel distance for an individual student Driver is 350 miles, emergent inclement weather, and route alterations due to traffic patterns, etc.) will be weighed and approved on a case-by-case basis.

Rental Vehicles

- Any student or staff member driving a rental vehicle or GW Fleet vehicle on behalf of a student organization must be an authorized driver. Drivers must be reauthorized each academic year.
- Parents, alumni, coaches, and other individuals not officially affiliated with GW may not drive for student organizations.
- Only authorized drivers who are 20+ may and have one year of driving experience may drive rental vehicles. Students must be 21+ to drive a 10-12 passenger van. 15 passenger vans are not permitted for GW travel.
- See the [Travel Reservations and Expenses section](#) below for more information on securing a rental vehicle.

Becoming an Authorized Driver

- Students must complete the [authorized driver application](#). Following the submission, a Motor Vehicle Records (MVR) check will occur.
- If a student passes the MVR check, they will be prompted to complete an online driver safety training. An additional road test is required for 10-12 passenger vans.
- Drivers must reapply for authorization each academic year, regardless of the date previously approved.
- Students are not authorized to drive a rental vehicle until they receive a notification stating approved driver status. The process can take several weeks, so plan accordingly.

Personal Vehicles

Students are strongly discouraged from using personal vehicles for student organization travel.

- For students who use their own personal vehicles, be advised that there is no coverage offered by GW, (i.e. no coverage for physical damage and no coverage for liability). The student would need to seek coverage from their personal insurance company. In no event will GW's automobile insurance policy respond to any vehicles that are driven by a student that are not owned, leased, or rented by GW.
- We recommend that any student who is in need of transportation for a GW-sponsored event use public transit or secure commercial transportation or a rented vehicle per the guidelines below.

Taxis and Rideshare (Uber, Lyft, etc.)

When traveling locally, organizations are encouraged to use public transportation and taxis rather than rideshare options (e.g., Uber, Lyft). **Student organizations will not be reimbursed for rideshare expenses and may not use GW P-cards for rideshare travel.**

Uber Vouchers

If an organization wishes to use a Rideshare app and pay with university funds, organizations may request an Uber Voucher for approved RSO events, programs, and conferences. The voucher will be added to an individual's personal Uber account and charged to the organization.

- RSOs must submit a purchase request in RevConnect to initiate the request. RSOs are required to upload a copy of the receipt (or voucher usage confirmation) in RevConnect to close out the purchase request.
- Purchase requests must be submitted at least **3 days in advance of local travel and 1 week in advance of domestic travel.**
- Vouchers will be issued in the amount requested and approved. RSOs will only be charged for the amount used. Unused balances will expire and cannot be repurposed or reimbursed.
- Uber transactions may be audited at any time. Misuse of vouchers (e.g., for personal travel) may result in the loss of privileges.
- Campus Rec will provide vouchers to Club Sports and TRAILS on an as needed basis.
- Uber Vouchers are designed for individuals and small groups and are not meant to replace rentals or shuttle services for larger group travel.

Peer-to-Peer Lodging Guidelines

Peer-to-Peer lodging (e.g. AirBnB, VRBO) is not allowed for students traveling on GW/student organization business that is funded or reimbursed by the University, including using student organization funds. Visit the [Lodging Peer-to-Peer Guidelines website](#) for more information.

If the use of peer-to-peer lodging is deemed necessary for the completion of the organization's mission, students must obtain prior written approval from the Division for Student Affairs who will consult with the Risk Management office to assess the request in advance of travel. Note that a detailed response from the host is required to approve requests.

Travel Reservations and Expenses (Hotels, Airfare/Bus/Train, Vehicle Rentals, Charter Bus)

Individuals and groups traveling on behalf of their RSO and utilizing organizational funds must make arrangements and reservations in advance via Org Help unless otherwise noted below. This section

details policies related to making reservations and facilitating travel-related expenses. All student organizations that are traveling must follow the general travel policies discussed in the Handbook.

The university does not pay for travel insurance. Students who add travel insurance to a reservation may be held personally liable for reimbursing the university for these costs.

Club Sport teams will still submit payment requests but will work with their Advisor/Campus Recreation to make travel arrangements and reservations.

The **Student Bar Association** and their affiliated sub-organization will coordinate reservations and finances through the GW Law School.

The **Medical Center Student Council** (MCSC) and their affiliated sub-organizations will coordinate reservations and finances through the primary MCSC RevConnect account.

Hotels

- To utilize organizational funds for a hotel reservation, the organization must submit an RevConnect purchase request **at least two (2) weeks prior** to the travel date.
- Hotel reservations are mainly booked through hotels.com unless your organization has a special rate or block booking already in place at the hotel.
- If the booking is reserved directly through the hotel, the organization is responsible for contacting the hotel, requesting the hotel's credit card authorization form, and submitting the form to Org Help for completion. The completed form will be returned to the hotel by Org Help, allowing the organization to check in without the physical GW P-card.
- Some hotels may request an individual's credit card be on file for room charges and incidentals. The university P-card will only be authorized to cover the cost of the room (including hotel fees and taxes).
- Organizations must send the itemized hotel receipt to Org Help through the payment request chat feature within five (5) business days following their return.

Vehicle Rentals

- RSOs wishing to rent a car for organizational travel must do so through Org Help. Enterprise is the preferred company. Other companies may be considered if Enterprise is not available.
- All Enterprise car rental requests must be submitted via an RevConnect payment request. Rental vehicle availability is based on local inventory and cannot be guaranteed. **Requests should be submitted 3-4 weeks in advance.** All vehicle rental bookings and confirmations will be available during the week of the rental.
- Purchase requests, including reimbursements, will be denied for costs related to non-approved rental cars or for driving expenses (fuel, tolls, etc.) for unauthorized drivers.
- Drivers must follow these [reporting guidelines](#) for any accident involving a rental vehicle. Additionally, drivers must inform Org Help (orgfinance@gwu.edu) of any accidents or damages.
- Only authorized drivers are permitted to drive rental vehicles.

Review the above Driving section and the [Auto Rental Guidelines website](#) for more information.

Airfare and Bus/Train Tickets

- To utilize RSO funds for an airfare reservation, bus/train tickets, the organization must submit an RevConnect payment request **at least two (2) weeks prior to the travel date**.
- Purchases will be facilitated by Org Help via the GW P-Card.
- When searching for airfare rates, we advise RSOs to use the [GW iBuy travel portal](#).
- The university allows organizations to pay for standard checked baggage fees. Expenditures for these fees must be reasonable and prudent and must be properly documented.
- Ancillary airline fees associated with priority boarding and economy class upgrades (e.g., Early Bird, Economy Plus, extra legroom, exit row, aisle seat, etc.) may not be added to a P-Card purchase and are not reimbursable.
- Travel insurance is not reimbursable and may not be added to a P-Card purchase.

Charter Bus/Bus Rental

- Organizations wishing to charter a bus or other form of transportation must utilize a transportation vendor [approved](#) by the Office of Risk Management. RSOs should work with Org Help to reserve the bus and complete any contracts.

International Travel Overview

Visit the [What is GW related or Supported Travel website](#) to determine if your trip qualifies as student organization travel.

International travel follows a distinct review and approval process. Applications for RSO international travel must be submitted **at least eight (8) weeks prior to the proposed departure date** and include as much detail as possible.

Failure to complete and submit the information within the necessary timeline may result in forfeiture of your trip.

All GW-sponsored or GW-related international travel by students or RSOs requires prior approval as outlined in the university's [international travel policy](#). Travelers must also adhere to GW's insurance, travel security, and related requirements. Visit the [GW Global International Travel website](#) for more information.

RSOs and individuals are not permitted to make travel arrangements until an application has been approved.

Eligibility

- Red and Blue Line organizations may apply for international travel.
- Orange and Green Line organizations must obtain written approval from the Division for Student Affairs before applying.

- Organizations must be in good standing with the Division for Student Affairs (e.g., no negative finance accounts, no disciplinary sanctions).
- Individuals participating in international travel may not have any disciplinary sanctions that preclude them from international travel.

GW- and Organization-Related Travel

International travel is considered GW and/or student organization-related when:

- The travel is undertaken because an individual is acting in an academic or professional capacity relevant to the person's areas of responsibility, activities (including co-curricular and extracurricular ones), course of research, teaching, or study at GW, and/or
- The travel is undertaken with or organized by any GW organization, division, department, or office, even if not for an academic or professional purpose, and/or
- The travel is partially or fully funded by the university.

International Travel Applications

Application Process

All organizations interested in international travel must submit the “**High Risk Travel Proposal for Groups**,” regardless of destination and group size. This form can be found on the [Planning GW Related or Supported Travel](#) website.

Organizations traveling as a group (with shared travel arrangements and itinerary) must designate one point of contact to submit one application on behalf of the organization. Once approved, each traveler will be instructed to register their travel in GW Passport.

All applications must include a thorough review of the travel destination's safety and security profile. The application must provide thorough risk mitigation plans. The High Risk Travel Proposal for Groups contains links to websites to assist organizations in identifying risk mitigation measures.

Review and Approval

Submitted applications will be reviewed by the Division for Student Affairs, then forwarded to the Assistant Dean of Student Engagement and the Office of Risk Management, before being sent for final approval by the Office of International Programs.

At any point during the review and approval process, the organization may be asked to provide additional information, clarify details, or make adjustments to plans. High-risk destinations may require an additional level of review and approval.

If approved, you will receive communication from the Office of International Programs prompting you to view and complete your travel registration requirements online using GW Passport. You will need to log on and complete the registration, including purchasing the required travel insurance. **Do not make travel arrangements until your trip has been approved.**

Trip leaders are required to attend an [Emergency Protocols Training](#) in advance of international travel, as are any GW faculty or staff accompanying the student organization, if applicable. The Assistant Dean of Student Engagement will also attend the training.

GW Brand, Merchandise, and Copyright Guidelines

POLICY SUMMARY

RSOs that want to use the [university's trademark names and logos \(PDF\)](#) on a shirt or other merchandise must follow the GW's [trademark guidelines](#), use a [licensed vendor](#), and get [the design approved by LTP](#).

Copyrighted work, including music, photos, and movies, cannot be copied, performed, distributed, or displayed without permission from the copyright holder. RSOs who violate copyright laws are subject to fines and university discipline.

GW Brand Guidelines and Purchasing Merchandise

- The Licensing and Trademarks Program (LTP) promotes and regulates the use of GW's federally trademarked names and identifying marks.
- Proper usage of the George Washington University ("GW" or the "university") name, logos, seal, and colors is important to the image and integrity of the university.
- All organizations must follow [the George Washington University Name, Logo, Seal, and Color Usage Policy](#) and the [GW Identity Standards & Guidelines](#) to ensure that all entities at the university are presented in a unified visual style.
- Organizations are permitted to create their own logos; however, organizations must not incorporate or misuse the GW logo (e.g., adding text to the GW logo, changing the color of the GW logo, overlaying graphics on the GW logo).
 - Note: Clubs Sports teams must use a GW approved Club Sport logo for their uniforms and apparel purchases. See "Club Sports - Additional Information" for more information.

Using the GW Trademarks and Logos for Merchandise

- Common examples of "merchandise" purchased by RSOs include shirts, hats, backpacks, mugs, pens, and other promotional items.
- RSOs that use university funds (e.g., Revenue, Budget, Department) must include "GW", "George Washington University", or [other approved wordmark or logo](#).
- If your merchandise has "GW", "George Washington University" or any of the [wordmarks owned by the university](#), it must be [approved by the licensing and trademarks](#) department and follow the [trademark guidelines](#) prior to printing.
- All merchandise must be purchased from a university-approved [licensed vendor](#).
- Additional information, including enforcement of policies, can be found on the [Trademark Guidelines website](#) and the [Merchandise Guidelines for Student Organizations \(PDF\)](#).

Apparel and Merchandise Sales

Organizations are responsible for a 6% DC sales tax on the sale of apparel and merchandise. Sales taxes will be withheld by Org Help when they are deposited into your RevConnect Group Funds account.

The term “sales tax included” must be added to sales language. For example, included on signs or in RevConnect stores when selling food or apparel.

Copyrighted Materials

POLICY RESOURCE

The GW Himmelfarb Health Sciences Library developed this [Copyright Basics](#) guide with helpful information and resources.

Copyright is a form of protection provided by U.S. law to authors of “original works of authorship” from the time the works are created in a fixed form.

A copyrighted work cannot be copied, performed, distributed, or displayed without permission from the copyright holder. Examples of copyrightable works include literary works, musical works, dramatic works, choreographic works, pictorial and graphic works, and more.

Registered student organizations are expected to know what is permitted under copyright law; to respect the rights of copyright holders; and to utilize copyrightable works in compliance with laws, university policies, and any binding agreements. In addition to consulting with your Advisor and Org Help, RSOs should review [Copyright Basics](#), a publication of the U.S. Copyright Office and other publications of the [U.S. Copyright Office](#) to better understand U.S. copyright law.

Users of copyrighted works ultimately bear the responsibility for complying with the law and any permissions, licenses or other agreements granting a right to use a work. Violation of a holder’s rights in a copyrighted work may result in statutory or other damages, fines, or more severe penalties.

The university may require the presentation of proof that permission to use a copyrighted work, as planned, had been obtained. The university reserves the right to bar the showing of a film, playing of music, or other use of a copyrighted work if there are reasonable concerns that the showing, playing, or use may violate the rights of the holder of the copyright.

Fair Use

Generally, fair use is any copying of copyrighted material done for a limited and “transformative” purpose. (“Copying” can mean both creating a physical copy of a work or an excerpt of it, or inserting a work or excerpts of it into another work.) The most common recognized “transformative” purposes are commentary, criticism, and parody. Whether or not a student organization’s use of copyrighted work falls within the boundaries of fair use is determined by weighing several factors.

As a general rule, organizations should not assume fair use applies to any copyrightable work that they desire to use. All student organizations should consult with a Org Help professional staff member before using any copyrighted material to determine whether appropriate permissions must be obtained.

Public Domain and Image Libraries

In general, U.S. copyright for anything created in 1978 or later lasts for the life of the author plus seventy years after the author's death; at which point the work becomes part of the public domain. Works are also in the public domain if they were created in 1927 or earlier. Any copyrightable work developed between 1928 and 1977 is subject to an individual assessment on whether it is in the public domain. When something is in the public domain, the work is owned by the public and organizations do not need to seek permission to use it.

Royalty-free and public domain resources include:

- [Pixaby](#): Royalty-free images & royalty-free stock
- [Project Gutenberg](#): 60,000+ eBooks that can be downloaded
- [Metropolitan Museum of Art](#): includes more than 400,000 images from The Met collection.
- [Smithsonian Institution Public Domain Images](#): a collection of 3,000+ images housed on Flickr.
- [Prelinger Archives](#): thousands of public domain films (advertising, educational, industrial, and amateur).

You can also utilize a [Google Advanced Search](#) to filter by usage rights. Learn more about the different [Creative Commons Licenses](#) here.

Common Copyright Situations

Each use of a copyrighted work raises unique questions. See below for common situations in which an RSO may need to obtain permission from a copyright owner. Note that this is not an all-inclusive list and organizations are ultimately responsible for ensuring compliance with copyright laws. RSOs should speak with their advisor or Org Help for assistance on any copyright questions.

Images

Most photographs/images are copyrighted, and their use is subject to copyright restrictions. RSOs must only utilize images for which they have confirmed permission either because the image is in the public domain, a Creative Commons license exists, or a license was obtained directly from the copyright owner.

Music Licensing

GW has agreements with the four main Performance Right Organizations (PROs). These agreements allow organizations to play or perform music at university events and functions on campus at no

additional cost. Check the [music catalogs](#) with these companies before playing music at your events. GW's music licenses do not cover music posted by its community members on the web or social media.

Visit the Licensing and Trademark Programs [Music Licensing website](#) for more information. Email ltl@gwu.edu with questions.

Films and Movies

Films and movies can be played publicly only with a proper license. Generally, no film or movie rental, purchase, or stream carries the right to exhibit it outside an individual's home. See Showing TV Shows, Movies, & Other Films in the Events section of this Handbook for more information.

Publicity, Marketing, and Communications

Postering Guidelines

Registered student organizations may display posters that promote an event, exhibit, or activity; recruit members; or express an opinion. The university's [Poster Policy](#) sets forth the criteria and responsibilities for the temporary display of posters on university-owned or leased property.

The term “poster” for purposes of this policy includes, but is not limited to, banners, flags, sandwich boards, flyers, leaflets, and chalking.

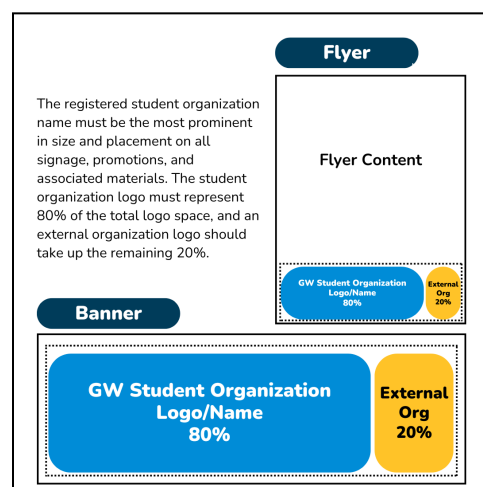
The approval of a poster or use of the university name or logo on a poster does not constitute an endorsement by the university of the program, event, or activity.

Review the [Poster Policy for the full university policy](#). Below are key points outlined in the policy:

- Event-related posters can be displayed a maximum of 15 days before the event. Non-event posters are limited to a 17-day display period.
- Exterior and interior posting locations on university-owned or leased property are restricted to [Identified Display Areas](#). One poster per poster location.
- The name and contact information for the student organization must be clearly displayed.
- The following are the allotted size dimensions for printed materials:
 - No larger than 8.5” by 11” for flyers (allotted size for bulletin boards)
 - No larger than 11" by 17" for posters
- Chalking on university- owned or leased property may only be done on horizontal concrete, granite, or asphalt surfaces where the rain will wash away the residue completely.
- Pushpins can be used to hang a poster on a bulletin board. Tape, preferably kinds that do not leave behind residue (e.g., painter’s tape), should be used to hang all other posters.
- Organizations may not project words or images onto the interior or exterior surfaces of any university-owned or leased property.

RSOs must also adhere to the following:

- Content must not promote alcohol or other drug consumption.
- When an event is hosted by an RSO in partnership with an external organization, the name of all the participating organizations must be included. The host RSO name must be the most prominent in size and placement on all signage, promotions, and associated materials. The RSO logo must represent at least 80% of the total logo space, and an external organization logo may take up no more than the remaining 20% (see illustration for examples).



GW residential, recreational, academic, support, administrative, or leased buildings may have additional policies and procedures for displaying posters in their areas.

RSOs may be financially responsible for damage or cleaning fees that result from hanging posters or chalking in unauthorized locations or using unapproved hanging methods.

Tabling

RSOs may reserve outdoor space and indoor space in the University Student Center, Kogan Plaza, Mid-campus Quad, and District House for the purposes of tabling. Tabling is commonly used to promote an RSO or conduct fundraising activities. To reserve table space, visit the [Student Center website](#).

GW Email Address and Listservs

GW Organization Email Address

Registered student organizations are eligible to create an organizational email address via GW IT. It is recommended that organizations use an @gwu.edu email address which better allows the university to help transition the account over time and address security and privacy concerns.

The RSO is responsible for maintaining the account and updating authorized users. Student Involvement does not monitor or maintain RSO email accounts or passwords; however, GWIT can assist with access issues, password resets, and functionality issues.

Before requesting an email account, read the [Code of Conduct for Users of Computing Systems and Services](#) and the [Network Usage and Security Policy](#).

Visit the [GWIT Organizational Email Account website](#) for more information or to submit an email request form. You will be asked to list the name and email of a sponsor that authorized the creation of an account. Organizations may list their advisor or email orghelp@gwu.edu for assistance.

GW Listserv

GW provides an email list management service using the L-Soft Listserv product. Listserv provides the means to manage all of your opt-in email lists, including email newsletters, announcements, discussion groups, and email communities. Student organizations with a GW organizational email address and Staff Advisor or Org Help approval may own a Listserv.

All list owners are required to adhere to the [GW Email Policy](#) and Acceptable Use of IT Resources Policy. Visit the [GWIT Listserv website](#) to learn more or to request a new list.

Additionally, organizations may [utilize RevConnect to email its members or officers](#).

Media - Campus Press and External Press

Organizations are permitted to speak to the media, both internal and external to the university. RSOs are encouraged to consult their advisor or Org Help for guidance upon receiving a media inquiry. Students may speak on behalf of their RSO, but may not represent the university or a GW department without written permission from the university's Media Relations team. Media Relations may be contacted at GWMedia@gwu.edu for guidance on media requests.

Student Media

Registered student organizations can submit letters to the editor, opinion pieces, and story ideas, as well as place advertisements in the GW Hatchet. Visit the [GW Hatchet website](#) for more information.

GW's campus radio station has a strong and devoted followership. Capitalize on this by working with WRGW on your event, pitching a blog, or advertising with WRGW. For more information on WRGW District Radio advertising, visit the [WRGW website](#).

Also consider tapping into other student media organizations on campus such as [GWTV](#).

University Calendar

The University Calendar pulls public events from RevConnect so it is helpful for organizations to add events to RevConnect to maximize reach. Also, the University Calendar is used to populate several GW websites, campus social media accounts, and official university communications to the student body.

Again, adding events in RevConnect remains the best way of getting them advertised to the community but if you want to add an event to the University Calendar without RevConnect [complete this online form](#). Log in using your GW UserID.

GWToday

GW Today is the official online news source for the university. The newsletter typically publishes interesting stories that highlight the accomplishments or activities of a wide variety of campus community members. In order to be considered for a story in GWToday, contact External Relations at gwtoday@gwu.edu.

Honor Society Email Invitation Guidelines

Student Involvement will send email invitations for membership on behalf of student organizations if the following conditions are met:

1. Invitations are sent to a select group of students based on FERPA-protected data such as GPA;

2. The student organization is categorized as Honorary;
3. The student organization is a chapter of a national organization; and
4. The national organization provides content for the email invitation, including directions for how recipients should contact the national organization to seek membership.

Organizations wishing to take advantage of this opportunity may make a request to their staff advisor. They should include clear criteria for generating the list of recipients. Organizations are limited to one mailing per semester (fall, spring, and summer).

At this time, the Division for Student Affairs is able to provide mail-merge services (i.e. individualized invitations) for honor organizations.

The emails will include the following disclaimer:

You are receiving this message because you meet the eligibility requirements for a national honor society whose GW chapter is a registered student organization. The national honor society is an independent entity and is not an agent, partner, or employee of the George Washington University. This email implies no endorsement of the national honor society's views or actions. You are under no obligation to take any action unless you wish to seek honor society membership through the means identified in this email.

Additional Information and Resources

Awards and Recognition

The annual [Excellence in Student Life Awards](#) is GW's largest celebration of student life and a beloved campus tradition, honoring the individuals and organizations that work tirelessly to enhance student life on campus and work alongside our surrounding community.

As a complement to the Excellence in Student Life Awards, the Division for Student Affairs hosts Day of Excellence, a community-wide celebration of appreciation and acclamation. This program provides all members of the community the opportunity to celebrate excellence on campus. This event is held annually during Buff and Bloom Week in April.

Organizational Conflict Management

Student Involvement and Conflict Education & Student Accountability (CESA) are available to assist student organizations in the resolution of organizational or interpersonal conflict. RSOS may contact orghelp@gwu.edu or cesa@gwu.edu.

Mail and Packages

Registered student organizations may direct mail and packages to their local address or utilize:

[RSO Name]
800 21st Street NW, Suite 204
Washington, DC 20052

Mail and packages sent to the above address will be collected by Org Help. If mail is received for your RSO, an email will be sent to the RSO's president and organization email (if applicable). Mail can be picked up during Org Help's office hours in University Student Center 433A.

Mail not picked up within 10 business days will be opened by Org Help staff. Checks will be deposited into the RSO's group funds account, important information may be scanned and emailed to officers, and mail determined to be junk mail (e.g. magazines, advertisements) will be discarded. Checks must be made payable to the George Washington University with the RSO name in memo line.

RSOs should not use an organization office address (i.e. USC 4th floor room numbers) as packages cannot be reliably delivered or tracked using these room numbers.

Officer Transition

Upon the transition of officers, the organization is responsible for the timely and effective transition of documents, passwords, and other materials and information. The Division for Student Affairs does not maintain this information on behalf of an RSO. The organization [must also update RevConnect](#) to accurately reflect the officers in its portal within ten (10) business days of transition.

Appendix 1: Club Sports Additional Information

DSE Platform Requirements and User Guide

- The Office of Campus Recreation uses a platform called Do Sports Easy (DSE) to manage club sport operations. Review this [DSE User Guide](#) for a detailed overview of how to use it.
- Every member of a Club Sports team must register on the DSE site and create a profile with your information, including address and emergency contact.
- All Club Sport participants (students, coaches, etc.) must read and digitally sign the Club Sports Waiver each academic year to participate. To complete the waiver, visit the [Campus Rec Club Sport DSE Page](#) and register as an athlete for the team(s) you play on.
- All Club Sport practices, matches, games, and tournaments must be registered by club leadership in DSE. Please follow the [User Guide](#).

Club Sports Travel Rules and Regulations

- All travel by any Club Sport teams must be approved by the Office of Campus Recreation at least 2-3 weeks in advance.
 - 2 weeks for activities requiring car rentals
 - 3 weeks for activities require flights
- Each club is solely responsible for its mode of transportation to and from club activities.
- Clubs are permitted to rent 10-12 passenger vans, minivans, and cars for travel. For 10-12 passenger vans, drivers must complete the online van safety test and an additional road test with GW Fleet.
- The university also recommends that Club Sport teams utilize charter motor coach service with professional drivers when applicable.

Driver Authorization and Vehicle Rentals

University Policies

- All drivers must be formally authorized to drive themselves or others for club-related activities.
- Students must be 20 years or older with at least one year of driving experience to be authorized to rent most vehicles. Students must be 21 years or older to be authorized to rent 10-12 passenger vans.
- Each authorized driver must follow the university [Vehicle Safety Policy](#), including limitations on daily mileage and time limitation.
- Enterprise is the preferred rental car company for GW. Clubs may use alternative rental car companies with the permission of the Office of Campus Recreation.

- See [Organization Travel](#) for more information.

Driver Authorization Steps for Club Sports

- Request to be an authorized driver in DSE when registering for a team or when you opt to take on this responsibility.
- Complete the Annual Driver Authorization Application in its entirety and the required training and tests provided by GW Fleet. See [Organization Travel](#) - Driving for the application and more information.
- Once authorized, your profile will be updated in DSE.

Requesting Rental Cars, Vans, Buses, Hotels, and Flights for Club Sports

Requirements for Travel Requests

- All travel requests must be submitted 2-3 weeks prior to the planned travel date.
- RevConnect accounts must have enough revenue to fund the entirety of the trip at the time of submission.
- Must have current authorized drivers. Drivers may not be just starting the authorization process at the time of submission because it could take up to 3 weeks to get cleared to drive.
- Must register an event in DSE and follow the [DSE User Guide](#).

Requesting Rental Cars, Vans, Buses, Hotels, and Flights

- Campus Recreation partners with Shorts Travel for the coordination of most Club Sports transportation.
- The Campus Rec team will submit requests directly to Shorts Travel on behalf of the club once all “Requirements for Travel Requests” have been met.
- Uber Vouchers will be provided on an as needed basis.
- Once pricing is provided for the request, enter a RevConnect purchase request.

Athletic Training / Injury Resources

Injury Reporting

All club sport injuries must be communicated to Campus Recreation via the [Injury Report Form](#) within 24 hours of the injury occurring. Any injury requiring a hospital visit should be communicated immediately by phone to your advisor.

Requesting an Athletic Trainer for Scheduled Events

High-risk sports will need to request an Athletic Trainer to be present for their home events. When completing your event registration in DSE, please indicate that your club needs an Athletic Trainer. The Department of Campus Recreation will attempt to find an athletic trainer through our G04 application. Clubs will be responsible for the cost of the athletic trainer.

Pre-participation Screening

It is highly recommended and encouraged to have an annual orthopedic and general physical examination prior to participating in any sporting or physical activity. The George Washington University Student Health Center provides complete pre-participation physical examinations.

Concussions

All players and coaches on Club Sports teams should be familiar with how to handle situations where a player on the team might have suffered a concussion. [Download the Sports Science Institute Concussion Fact Sheet for Student Athletes \(PDF\)](#) provided by the NCAA for more information. Additional resources are available through the [NCAA concussions website](#).

- Safety officers are responsible for knowing and understanding concussion protocol and attending any required training on the subject.
- Each year, all club sports participants (students, faculty, staff, etc.) must complete a waiver in DSE, which requires that participants review the Concussion Fact Sheet.

Team Uniforms, Apparel, and Logo Management

Logo Management

- All clubs must use a GW-approved Club Sport logo for their uniforms and apparel purchases. Custom logos are not permitted.
- To obtain your GW-approved Club Sport logo, contact recreation@gwu.edu.
- The Campus Recreation team will send the logo art for use on the design of uniforms and apparel.

Ordering Uniforms and Apparel

- Clubs must follow guidelines set by [GW Licensing and Trademarks](#) for all apparel purchases.
- Clubs must use [GW licensed vendors](#) to purchase apparel.
- The Office of Campus Recreation recommends using GameOne, as they are a licensed vendor. Their contact is Tyson Street at tyson.street@game-one.com.

- Once you have the artwork draft from the vendor, please submit to IMSports@gwu.edu and your Staff Advisor for a first sign-off on design.
- After receiving sign-off from Campus Recreation, [submit through GW Licensing and Trademarks website](#) for final sign-off from the university. See [GW Brand, Merchandise, & Copyright Guidelines for more information](#).

Club Sports Finances

All Club Sports expenditures are managed through RevConnect purchase requests. Club Sports finance officers work with the designated Campus Recreation Org Help Finance team member to facilitate purchases and travel reservations.

Visit the [Finances](#) section of this Handbook, including the Club Sports sub-section, for more details on Club Sports Finances.

Appendix 2: Events with Alcohol

Policy

Eligibility and Scope

Any registered student organization hosting a student organization-sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages are consumed, served, or sold (referred to as an “event with alcohol”) must register the event with the Division for Student Affairs through [RevConnect](#). Only RSOs in good standing (e.g., not frozen) in the Red, Blue, Orange (grad-only), and Green Line Pathways are permitted to host and RSO-sponsored events with alcohol. Other RSOs, unregistered student groups, and individual students are not permitted to register a student organization-sponsored event with alcohol.

Compliance with the law and university policies.

RSOs wishing to initiate a student organization-sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages will be served must comply with all university policies and all applicable federal, state and local laws pertaining to the procurement, sale, and/or distribution of alcoholic beverages.

University Authority

- University officials may inspect the event at any time and shall have the absolute right to terminate the event/activity or the service of alcoholic beverages at the event/activity. If directed to terminate the sponsored event, the sponsor(s) must immediately cease the event.
- While a reported violation of these Procedures is being investigated by the university, the university, which includes but is not limited to, an academic college or university department, Student Involvement, and Conflict Education and Student Accountability, reserves the right to pause the review process, instruct the Sponsors to pause any efforts to fulfill duties under this Policy, or revoke the registration for any pending student organization-sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages may be served for the sponsoring organization(s).
- The George Washington University reserves the right to update and modify any of the terms and regulations contained within these Procedures, at any time and in our sole discretion.

Event Registration and Review Process

Organizations wishing to initiate an event with alcohol **must create an event for their organization in RevConnect** and complete the embedded questionnaire regarding the presence of alcohol.

- RSOs must submit an event registration form for a sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages will be served for activities, including but not limited to, those that are advertised by,

partially or wholly funded by, hosted or co-hosted by, or facilitated on behalf of the student organization(s) which take place on or off university premises.

- Event registration must be submitted in RevConnect at least two (2) weeks prior to the event.
- RSOS will receive an email confirmation from the RevConnect system once the event registration form is submitted confirming registration. Events are not considered approved until the Division for Student Affairs communicates final approval.
- Pursuant to university policies governing RSOs entering into binding contracts with non-university companies, contracts between Third-Party Vendors & University-Approved Vendors and RSOs must be submitted through the Contract Request Form or Law School (for SBA organizations) at least 4-6 weeks prior to the intended activity's date. All contracts are to be reviewed through Org Help or designated office and must comply with these procedures.

Event Requirements

- **Time of Event.** RSO-sponsored events with alcohol may not take place between the day after the last day of classes until the conclusion of final exams. These days include, but are not limited to, the published university reading days, make-up days, or final exam days. Undergraduate student organizations' timeline will follow the published university academic calendar. Graduate and professional RSOs will follow the academic calendar for their designated school if it is different from the university academic calendar.

Unless otherwise specified by other published university policies, alcoholic beverages may only be served, sold, and consumed at RSO-sponsored activities during the following hours: Sunday through Thursday, 2:00 p.m.-11:30 p.m., and Friday and Saturday, 2:00 p.m.-1:30 a.m.

- **Event Authority.** RSOs must hire a university-approved Event Authority for any student organization-sponsored event with alcohol. Students may not serve as the Event Authority.

For on-campus events, the Event Authority may provide these services in coordination with the organization's designated sober monitors as outlined below:

The Event Authority can conduct age verification, monitor entrances and exits to the event, conduct wristbanding for drink ticket distribution, and distribute alcohol in accordance with the chosen system (drink tickets or cash bar, as outlined in below). The vendor should be staffed appropriately relative to the event size.

If the sponsored activity is taking place at a Third-Party Vendor site or with a University-Approved Vendor, regardless of location, employees from the respective vendor must be identified as Event Authorities.

Event Authorities must be notified by the sponsoring RSO(s) of the authorized system and procedures pertaining to the distribution of alcoholic beverages prior to the activity taking place.

- **Risk Manager.** Each organization wishing to host events with alcohol must designate a risk manager on the event registration. The risk manager will be responsible for ensuring compliance with all events with alcohol policies, and overseeing sober monitors. The risk manager will be

required to complete a training at the beginning of the academic year on safety practices and addressing overconsumption. Organizations whose designated risk manager does not attend the training will not be permitted to host events with alcohol until the training is completed.

- **Points of Contact.** RSOs intending to host or co-host an event with alcohol must identify the Primary and Secondary Contacts for the sponsored activity on the RevConnect event form.
 - The Primary Contact will be responsible for the Sponsor(s) overall adherence to university policy and the law at the sponsored activity. This student will oversee the implementation of the authorized system for the distribution of alcoholic beverages at the sponsored activity. This individual will work with Event Authorities and any university official in addressing any violation(s) of university policy and the law and in circumstances when the health and safety of attendees may be at risk.
 - The Secondary Contact will assist the Primary Contact in complying with university policy and the law at the sponsored activity and working with Event Authorities and any university official in implementation of the authorized system for the distribution of alcoholic beverages at the sponsored event.
 - Primary Contacts and Secondary Contacts who fail to adhere to their respective responsibilities at a RSO-sponsored event with alcohol may be subject to removal from the sponsored activity, be ineligible to participate in a sponsored activity in the future in the same role, and/or be subject to administrative and/or conduct action by the university. Should this occur, the sponsoring student organization(s) may also be subject to administrative and/or conduct action by the university.
- **Sober Monitors.** RSOs intending to host or co-host an event with alcohol must identify the required number of sober monitors for the sponsored activity on the RevConnect event form.
 - Sober monitors are enrolled students in the sponsoring organization(s) who will refrain from consuming alcoholic beverages the day of and during the sponsored activity.
 - Undergraduate student organizations must identify at least one (1) sober monitor for every twenty-five (25) anticipated attendees at a sponsored activity. Graduate student organizations must identify at least one (1) sober monitor for every fifty (50) anticipated attendees at a sponsored activity. Primary and Secondary Contacts can count towards the number of required sober monitors.
 - The responsibilities of a sober monitor will include but are not limited to, assisting the Primary Contact, the Secondary Contacts, Event Authorities, and any university official in addressing any violation(s) of university policy or the law, or assisting in circumstances when the health and safety of attendees may be at risk. A sober monitor must be aware of and follow the authorized system for the distribution of alcoholic beverages at the sponsored activity and must stay at the sponsored activity throughout its duration. A sober monitor will also ensure that substantial food and non-alcoholic beverages are available for consumption at the sponsored activity.
 - Sober monitors who fail to adhere to their respective responsibilities at an RSO-sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages are served may be subject to removal from the sponsored activity, be ineligible to participate in a sponsored activity in the future in the same role, and/or be subject to administrative and/or conduct action

by the university. Should this occur, the sponsoring RSO(s) may also be subject to administrative and/or conduct action by the university.

- **Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages.** Food and non-alcoholic beverages must be provided by the sponsor(s) for consumption throughout the duration of the sponsored activity at no cost to participants. Food provided should be substantial and must be appropriate for the number of attendees and the duration of the event. Specific details regarding quantity and type of food and non-alcoholic beverages offered must be provided on the event registration form. Adherence to this standard will be evaluated by the event reviewer(s) and approved or denied at the discretion of designated reviewer(s).
- **Drinking contests or games of any kind are prohibited.**
- **Alcohol cannot be donated** for a RSO-sponsored event with alcohol.
- **Businesses or companies in the alcohol industry (e.g., importers/producers, distributors) cannot co-sponsor student organization-sponsored events with alcohol.**

Beverage Distribution

If registration is approved, alcoholic beverages may be served or sold to individuals who are 21 years of age and older at RSO-sponsored activities through a cash bar system or a drink ticket system as described within these procedures. Open bar and Bring Your Own (BYO) systems are prohibited.

- Only one system of alcoholic beverage distribution may be utilized at a student organization-sponsored activity.
- Unless otherwise specified by other published university policies, alcoholic beverages may only be served by personnel of a University-Approved Vendor or a Third-Party Vendor that is certified/licensed to serve alcohol and must follow the authorized system for the distribution of alcoholic beverages.
- For activities occurring in the University Student Center, all servers shall be under the supervision of a manager provided by the University-Approved Vendor.
- The vendor/server must provide written acknowledgment of its understanding, compliance, and enforcement of these procedures and its respective jurisdictional laws, to include D.C. laws, governing the service of alcohol as part of the registration process.
- Attendees may not bring alcoholic beverages to, or remove alcoholic beverages from, the designated area of the sponsored activity.
- If the sponsored activity is a fundraiser, the cash bar distribution system must be utilized. Monies collected from alcohol sales cannot be counted towards funds raised.

Drink Ticket System

- A drink ticket must be purchased from or provided by a Third-Party Vendor or a University-Approved Vendor to be exchanged for one alcoholic beverage during the RSO-sponsored activity.

- Whenever drink tickets are sold, the Third-Party Vendor or a University-Approved Vendor must have a current license or certification within the appropriate jurisdiction associated with the lawful procurement, sale, and/or distribution of alcoholic beverages.
- Graduate school student organizations, if authorized by their Advisor, and the venue, may pre-purchase alcoholic beverages from a Third-Party Vendor or a University-Approved Vendor for distribution to persons of legal age during a student organization-sponsored activity. In these circumstances, a person of legal age must be provided a drink ticket in order to obtain an alcoholic beverage during the sponsored-activity.
- Drink tickets can be made available only at the time of an individual's arrival to the event.
- No more than three (3) drink tickets can be provided to an individual attendee at a student organization-sponsored activity.
- The maximum number of drink tickets that can be made available for distribution to each attendee shall depend upon the intended and/or remaining duration of the sponsored activity. The number of tickets available declines with the remaining time of the sponsored activity:
 - Events that are less than two hours: 1 drink ticket
 - Events between two and three hours: 2 drink tickets
 - Events between three and four hours: 3 drink tickets
 - Events with alcohol may not be longer than four hours.

Responsibilities at the Event

- The Third-Party Vendor, University-Approved Vendor, Event Authority, and the Sponsor(s), are responsible for managing the property during the sponsored activity and have the authority to supervise the delivery, storage, service, consumption, and removal of alcoholic beverages to and from the location of the activity.
 - If the Sponsor(s) violates this Policy or other university policies, or if public safety concerns so warrant, the Third-Party Vendor, the University-Approved Vendor, Event Authority, a university official, or law enforcement officials shall have the right to terminate the activity or the service of alcoholic beverages at the activity.
 - If directed to terminate the sponsored activity, the Sponsor(s) must immediately cease the activity.
- Sponsors are responsible for the behavior and conduct of their members and their guests at any sponsored event with alcohol. Violations of law, these procedures, or other university policies at events with alcohol may result in administrative and/or conduct action for the hosting or co-hosting student organization and/or the respective individual students.
- Should a violation of university policy be determined prior to a sponsored activity taking place, the Division for Student Affairs Student Involvement Team and Conflict Education and Student Accountability shall have the right to immediately withdraw prior approval granted for the event. Should this occur, the event no longer becomes a student-organization sponsored activity.
- Should violations of university policy or the law occur at a sponsored activity at which alcoholic beverages are served, which are observed by the Sponsor(s), Event Authority, university officials, including GYPD officers, a law enforcement agency, representatives of a D.C.-certified security agency (or similar in other jurisdictions), a Third-Party vendor, or a University Approved Vendor,

those individuals are authorized to take appropriate action to resolve the violation, to include the termination of the sponsored activity.

Promotion of the Event

- Promotion and publicity of sponsored activities cannot occur until the activity is approved and registered and must follow these procedures and the other published guidelines of the university's posting policies, including but not limited to the Code of Student Conduct and the Poster Policy.
- All advertisements, promotions and social media campaigns for registered events must include the following statement: "Alcohol will be available via the [INSERT DISTRIBUTION METHOD] for individuals 21 and over with a valid, government-issued ID."
- Promotion and publicity material for a sponsored activity, including but not limited to, banners, posters, palm cards, flyers, or any form of electronic media, etc. may not promote or emphasize illegal activity, drugs, alcohol, sexual situations, contain sexual innuendos, or disparaging individuals or groups on the basis of identity.

Definitions

- The "cash bar" system approved by the university is defined as the purchase of an alcoholic beverage from a Third-Party Vendor or a University-Approved Vendor with cash or a credit/debit card, whether the activity is to take place on or off university premises.
- The "drink ticket" system approved by the university is defined as an alcoholic beverage distribution system in which a single ticket is exchanged for a single alcoholic beverage.
- "Event Authorities" of a student organization-sponsored activity, include but are not limited to university officials (for example, GWPD officers, or other university employees), representatives of a D.C.-certified security agency (or similar agency in another local jurisdiction), and individuals employed by a Third-Party Vendor or a University-Approved Vendor, who will provide alcohol management services (for example, age verification) at such activities.
- "Legal age" means 21 years of age or older.
- An "open bar" system is defined as an alcoholic beverage distribution system in which consumption is not limited and distribution of alcoholic beverages is provided at no cost to individuals.
- The "Primary Contact" is sober and responsible for the student organization's overall adherence to university policy and the law at the sponsored activity.
- The "Secondary Contact" is sober and will assist the "Primary Contact" in complying with university policy and the law at the sponsored activity.
- A "Sober monitor" is a member of the student organization that is sponsoring the activity. They are required to refrain from consuming alcohol the day of and for the duration of the sponsored activity.
- "Sponsor" means the student organization(s) or student(s) on behalf of a student organization initiating, conducting, directing, or supervising the student organization sponsored-activity.

- A "Staff Advisor" is the university employee assigned as the Staff Advisor to the student organization. Advisor assignments are made by the Division for Student Affairs. Student Organizations that do not have an assigned Staff Advisor must utilize Org Help (orghelp@gwu.edu).
- "Student" means any currently enrolled person, full-time or part-time, or on continuous enrollment, pursuing undergraduate, graduate, or professional studies, whether or not in pursuit of a degree or any form of certificate of completion. An individual new to the university is a student for purposes of this Handbook on the first day of classes or when participating in any official university activity, whichever occurs first. "Official university activity" can include residence in university residential facilities.
- "Student group" means students who are associated with each other, but who have not complied with formal university requirements for registration as a student organization.
- "Student organization" (or "RSO") means any number of students who have complied with university requirements for registration with the Division for Student Affairs as a registered student organization.
- "Third-Party Vendors" means business establishments maintaining a current license or certification associated with the lawful procurement, sale, and/or distribution of alcoholic beverages in their respective jurisdictions.
- "University" means the George Washington University and all of its undergraduate, graduate, and professional schools, divisions, and programs.
- "University-Approved Vendors" means Third-Party Vendors that have been approved by the university for work at university-sponsored activities.
- "University premises" means buildings or grounds owned or leased by the university, or in which the university has an ownership interest, including, but not limited to, buildings or grounds in which students reside and university food service facilities are located; University Student Center facilities; Columbia Plaza; and facilities operated in the name of any officially registered student organization. This definition is not limited to buildings or grounds owned or leased by the university at the Foggy Bottom campus.
- "University-sponsored activities" means events and activities initiated by a student, student organization, or university department, faculty member, or employee that: Are expressly authorized, aided, conducted, or supervised by the university; or Are funded in whole or in part by the university; or Are initiated and conducted or promoted by an officially-registered student organization, university department, faculty member or employee.

Where not defined above, other terms in this policy use the definitions in the [Code of Student Conduct](#).